

DIGITALAIKART PRESENTS

The Complete Scholarship Handbook

2026 - 27 Season

Every central government scholarship on the National Scholarship Portal,
explained with verified eligibility, amounts and deadlines

20 NSP schemes covered scheme by scheme

INSPIRE and private scholarships outside NSP

The OTR and application walkthrough

The 8 rejection traps and how to dodge them

Verification pipeline, renewals and fraud protection

Facts verified from official sources as of 16 September 2026

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How to Use This Handbook

This handbook exists for one reason: in India, students lose scholarship money they are fully eligible for, every single year, because of paperwork and timing. Not because they did not deserve it. Because a certificate was from the wrong year, or the school never verified the form, or the deadline they heard on WhatsApp was the wrong one for their scheme.

The National Scholarship Portal currently runs 18 central schemes with income limits from Rs. 2.5 lakh to Rs. 8 lakh, and there is no single deadline for all of them: for the 2026-27 season, several schemes close on 30 September 2026 while most of the rest close on 31 October 2026. NMMSS alone had 79,398 fresh and 1,87,208 renewal applications as of 31 August 2026, and every rejected one of those was a student who thought submitting was the hard part.

Here is how to use this book, depending on who you are:

- If you are a school student (Class 9 to 12), read Part II first (documents and OTR), then the school-level scheme chapters: NMMSS and the PM YASASVI school schemes.
- If you are in college or starting college, start with CSSS, then the category scheme that matches you (SC, ST, OBC, EBC, DNT, disability), then the AICTE schemes if you are in a technical course.
- If you are a parent, read the chapters on documents, income certificates and the verification pipeline; you control the paperwork more than you think.
- If you are a science topper deciding what to study, read the INSPIRE chapter before you decide anything else.
- If your application was rejected last year, go straight to the rejection traps and the 'what to do now' chapters.

Three ground rules apply to everything in this handbook. First, everything here was verified from official sources on 16 September 2026: the National Scholarship Portal scheme listings, Press Information Bureau releases, and the official documents of the ministries and bodies that run each scheme. Second, portal listings can change mid-season, so the last word is always the official portal; this handbook tells you what to check and when, so you check it with your eyes open. Third, applying is always free. Anyone who asks you for money to get you a government scholarship is committing a crime.

A note on accuracy

This is a guide, not a government publication. Verify your specific scheme on the official portal before every submission. Nothing in this handbook replaces the official notification of your scheme.

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Part I. The Scholarship Landscape

Before you fill a single form, you need to understand the machine you are dealing with. This part explains how government scholarships in India actually work, what the National Scholarship Portal does, and the 2026-27 calendar. It takes twenty minutes to read and saves weeks of confusion.

How the system actually works

Almost every central government scholarship now flows through one website: the National Scholarship Portal, at scholarships.gov.in, run as a single online window for central schemes. Eighteen schemes sit on it for the 2026-27 session, run by different ministries: the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, the Ministry of Home Affairs, the Railway Board, the Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities, AICTE, UGC, the Labour Ministry and the Ministry of Education. You register once, upload your documents once, and apply to the schemes you are eligible for.

The money never touches a school, a college or an agent. Payments go by Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) into the bank account linked to your Aadhaar, in most schemes through the Public Financial Management System (PFMS). That single design change killed the era of scholarships going missing between the department and the student. What it also means is that your bank details, your Aadhaar and your name spelling have to match perfectly everywhere, because there is no human at a counter to fix a mismatch; there is only a database comparison.

Schemes split into two families. Merit-based schemes reward performance, like CSSS for the top percentile of Class 12 or INSPIRE for top-1-percent science students. Welfare-based schemes lower financial barriers for specific communities and situations, like the post-matric scholarships for SC, ST, OBC, EBC and DNT students, or the schemes for wards of workers and uniformed services. The portal allows you to apply for one merit-based scheme and one or more welfare-based schemes, subject to each scheme's eligibility conditions. Many students qualify for both at once, and there is generally no rule against holding more than one scholarship, though some schemes ask you to declare other awards.

The combining rule

One merit-based scheme plus one or more welfare-based schemes is allowed on the NSP. Read each scheme's rules about other awards before you assume you cannot combine them.

Your scholarship roadmap, Class 9 to PhD

Scholarship planning is a relay, not a single race. Here is what to run for at each stage of your education, so that no year goes by with free money sitting unclaimed:

When	What to run for
Class 7-8	Score at least 55 percent in Class 7 (50 percent for SC and ST) to stay eligible for NMMSS. If you are in a government school, this is the entry ticket.
Class 9	Apply for NMMSS after the state selection process. If you are OBC, EBC or DNT at a government school, apply for the YASASVI pre-matric scholarship too.
Class 10-11	Renew NMMSS and YASASVI every year. OBC, EBC and DNT students seeking Top Class Schools watch the YET conducted by NTA.
Class 11-12	Keep renewing. Aim at the Class 12 percentile: CSSS needs the top 20 percent of your board, INSPIRE needs the top 1 percent for science students.
Right after Class 12	CSSS fresh window (watch the portal), INSPIRE-SHE call announcement for basic sciences, and the Reliance Foundation scholarship for first-year UG students. Prepare the income certificate now, not in October.
First year of college	File your category scheme: post-matric OBC, EBC, DNT, SC or ST; AICTE Pragati or Saksham if in a technical course; the Jammu and Kashmir scheme if you are from the region and studying outside it.
PG level	The UGC National PG Scholarship when it opens, CSSS continuation at Rs. 20,000 a year where applicable, and Ishan Uday for North Eastern Region students.
Throughout	Track every state scheme for your category; state deadlines are usually earlier than central ones and the competition is thinner.

Merit versus welfare, and why the difference matters

This one distinction decides whether your application succeeds. Need-based schemes such as CSSS and most post-matric schemes combine a minimum academic bar with a family income ceiling. Their verification teams check your income certificate hardest. Merit-based schemes such as INSPIRE reward performance, and their verification teams check your marks and your course. A student who applies to a need-based scheme with a sloppy income certificate fails verification even with a great marksheet, and a student who applies to a merit scheme from an unsupported course fails even with 95 percent. Match the scheme to your strongest proof, not to its biggest amount.

The 2026-27 calendar: what closes when

The 2026-27 NSP session opened on 1 June 2026, and One Time Registration is required before any application. There is no single last date; the portal shows different closing dates by scheme, application type and student category. Here is the pattern as verified on 16 September 2026:

What	When
Portal opening for 2026-27	1 June 2026
NMMSS applications (extended)	30 September 2026
CSSS renewal applications	30 September 2026
PM-USP Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh renewal	30 September 2026
Pre-matric schemes (certain, including beedi workers' wards pre-matric)	30 September 2026
Most remaining schemes (Pragati, Saksham, Swanath, PMSS, YASASVI post-matric, Top Class, ST, disability post-matric and others)	31 October 2026
Defective application verification, most schemes	15 November 2026
Institute verification, most schemes	15 November 2026
DNO, SNO or MNO verification, most schemes	30 November 2026
UGC National PG Scholarship and Ishan Uday	Not yet opened as of early September 2026

Two lessons from that table. First, if you are in a scheme with a 30 September deadline, you have almost no time left; finish your documents this week. Second, the 31 October date is for submitting, not for everything: the verification stages run for a month after it, and your institute's nodal officer verifying your form is part of your application, not a favour.

The deadline rule

Never trust a single 'NSP last date' you see on social media or WhatsApp. There is no single date. Check your exact scheme on the official portal; several schemes close 30 September 2026, most others 31 October 2026.

How to read your scheme listing

Every scheme on the NSP has a listing page, and once you can read it, you can replace every rumour you have ever heard about scholarships with five fields. Here is what each one tells you:

Field on the listing	What it means for you
Merit or welfare based	Merit schemes ride on marks and exams; welfare schemes ride on category and income. Some rules, like the one-merit-plus-welfare combination rule, depend on which family you are in.
Fresh or renewal	The listing shows which windows are open. A scheme can be open for renewal and closed for fresh on the same day, as CSSS was in September 2026.
Application open from and last date	Your actual deadline. Ignore everything on social media and trust only this row.
Defective application verification open till	The correction window for flagged applications. If your status turns defective, this is the date that matters.
Institute verification open till	The date your school or college must finish Level 1. Your follow-up deadline.
DNO, SNO or MNO verification open till	The date for the district, state or ministry level. Nothing for you to do except check that the previous levels moved.

Make a habit of it: every Monday during the season, open your schemes' listings, note the dates, and check your application status. Five minutes, and you will never again be surprised by a deadline.

Where the money actually goes: the numbers

Government scholarship numbers are large, and that is exactly why an individual application feels invisible. It is not. These are the verified figures behind the schemes in this handbook, from official releases and scheme documents:

- NMMSS received 79,398 fresh and 1,87,208 renewal applications for 2026-27 by 31 August 2026, and awards one lakh fresh scholarships every year at Rs. 12,000 each.
- The PM YASASVI pre-matric component benefited 19.86 lakh students in 2023-24 with Rs. 193.83 crore allocated; the post-matric component benefited 27.97 lakh students with Rs. 988.05 crore released.
- The YASASVI Top Class college stream supported 4,762 students with Rs. 111.18 crore in 2023-24; the school stream supported 2,602 students with Rs. 6.55 crore.
- INSPIRE-SHE announces 12,000 scholarships every year, each worth Rs. 80,000, for basic and natural sciences students.

- The Reliance Foundation Undergraduate Scholarship awards 5,000 scholarships every year, worth up to Rs. 2 lakh each across the degree.
- Income limits across the NSP run from Rs. 2.5 lakh to Rs. 8 lakh depending on the scheme, so there is almost always a scheme your family income fits.

Read those numbers the right way. Every lakh of beneficiaries is a lakh of families who got the paperwork right. The system is not a lottery with one winner; it is a queue with a checklist, and the checklist is this handbook.

Part II. Before You Apply

Ninety percent of scholarship failures are created before a single form is filled. This part covers the document folder, the One Time Registration, and how to pick the schemes that match your proof.

Build the document folder first

Every scheme in this handbook asks for some combination of the same small set of documents. Collect them once, scan them clearly (PDF or JPG, under the portal's size limits, every corner visible), and keep them in one folder on your phone and one backup copy. The portal does not forgive blurry uploads; it marks them defective and puts you into the correction queue.

The master document checklist	
[]	Aadhaar card (the student's own, with the mobile number linked and working)
[]	Bank passbook first page showing the account number and the student's name, matching Aadhaar exactly
[]	Income certificate for the correct financial year, from the authorised revenue officer, within your scheme's limit
[]	Category certificate (SC or ST, lifetime validity; OBC non-creamy layer, valid for the current financial year)
[]	Disability certificate with the percentage stated, if applying under a disability scheme
[]	Marksheets: Class 10, Class 12 and the latest semester or course proof
[]	Admission receipt or bonafide certificate from your current institution
[]	Your institute's NSP code (ask the scholarship cell; never guess an AISHE code)
[]	A passport-size photograph in the portal's specified format
[]	Domicile certificate, if your scheme needs state proof (for example the Jammu and Kashmir scheme)

Three of these deserve special attention because they are the three that get applications killed. The income certificate must be for the right financial year and from the right authority; a certificate from the previous year, or from an officer who is not authorised, will be rejected at ministry verification. The OBC non-creamy layer certificate expires at the end of each financial year, unlike SC and ST certificates which are valid for life, so a fresh NCL certificate every year is the single most important April task for OBC families. And the bank account

name must match the Aadhaar name exactly: if your Aadhaar says 'Mohammed Faizan' and your passbook says 'Md Faizan', fix the bank record before you apply, because the DBT engine will compare them.

How to get each certificate, without the runaround

Every rejected application traces back to a certificate. Here is how the common ones are actually obtained, so you can start early enough that the paperwork is ready before the portal windows matter.

The income certificate

Issued by the authorised revenue officer of your district, usually the tehsil or block office, on the basis of self-declaration plus verification of income sources. Some states accept it through the e-district portal online. Two things must be right: the financial year on the certificate must be the current one, and the income stated must honestly cover all earning members of the family, because schemes count parents, spouse and guardians together. A certificate that understates income to fit a scheme limit is fraud, and verification compares declared income against records.

The OBC non-creamy layer certificate

The OBC NCL certificate is issued by the competent district authority on the prescribed form, based on income and status criteria for the parent's. The critical thing: it expires at the end of each financial year. The certificate you used last season is dead paper this season. Apply for the fresh one in April or May, before the NSP window opens, so the new certificate is in hand by June. This single habit prevents the most common OBC rejection of all.

SC and ST certificates

Issued by the competent revenue authority of your state and valid for life, which is why an old SC or ST certificate is usually fine. The trap is authority: the issuing officer must be one competent for caste certification in your state, and the certificate must show the community in the state's notified list for your caste. An SC certificate from the wrong issuing chain fails ministry verification.

The disability certificate

Issued by a designated medical authority under the Rights of Persons with Disabilities framework. The document must state the percentage of disability, because the portal's eligibility line is 40 percent or more and a certificate without a number cannot be compared against it. For progressive conditions, ask for reassessment rather than submitting an old lower figure.

The domicile certificate

Proof of residence in the state or region that a scheme requires, issued by the revenue authority. It matters most for the Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh special scholarship, the North Eastern Region schemes, and state scholarships. If your family has moved, check the state's continuous-residence rule before assuming you qualify.

How long each document stays valid

Document	Validity
Aadhaar card	Valid for life; keep the mobile link live, it carries every OTP
Income certificate	Current financial year only; renew every year
OBC non-creamy layer certificate	Expires at the end of each financial year; renew in April-May
SC or ST certificate	Valid for life, from the competent authority
Disability certificate	Valid while the stated percentage stands; reassess for progressive conditions
Domicile certificate	Valid while your residence facts hold; recheck after a family move
Marksheets and admission proof	Permanent records; keep scanned copies forever
Passport photo	Keep a recent one in the portal's specified format

One Time Registration (OTR): the gate to everything

For the 2026-27 project year, OTR is mandatory on the NSP before you can apply for anything. It is a one-time profile, keyed to your Aadhaar, that stays with you across your academic career. The portal issues you a 14-digit OTR number, and you use that with your password for every scholarship application from now on.

- 1 Keep an Aadhaar-linked mobile number ready; OTPs and notifications go there. Face authentication is required to generate the OTR number, so be prepared to complete that step on a phone with a working camera.
- 2 Complete the OTR fields exactly as they appear on your Aadhaar: name, date of birth, and the rest, character for character. This profile becomes the base every application copies from.
- 3 Wait for OTR approval. If it is pending beyond about 48 hours, recheck the Aadhaar-mobile link and the photograph quality, then contact the NSP helpline.
- 4 After OTR approval, use the portal's scheme search: enter your category, course level and income, and it shows the schemes you are eligible for.

- 5 Do not create a second account if you forget your password. Duplicate accounts with the same Aadhaar or mobile number get both accounts rejected. Use the 'Forgot Password' option.

Filing the form without OTR leaves the application incomplete on the portal; it is the equivalent of posting an envelope with no address on it. If your OTR is done, applications take minutes.

Fresh or renewal: the question that trips the most people

On the NSP, a fresh application is your first application under a scheme. A renewal application is what an existing beneficiary files each year to continue receiving it. The two windows have different dates, and the mistake goes both ways: renewal students who accidentally file fresh get flagged as duplicates, and fresh students who wait for a 'renewal opening' they heard about miss their own window entirely.

- If you received the scholarship last year, you are a renewal student. File renewal, do not file a second fresh application; NSP warns that duplicate fresh applications from renewal students get rejected.
- If you never received this scholarship, you are fresh. Your deadline is the scheme's fresh date, not the renewal date and not the other way around.
- The renewal option not showing usually means the scheme's renewal window has not opened yet, or your previous record has a data problem. Contact your institute's nodal officer; do not create a new account.
- CSSS in 2026-27 is the live example: renewals are open until 30 September 2026 while the fresh window had not opened as of early September. Two different clocks for the same scheme.

Picking your schemes: match proof to purpose

Do not pick the scheme with the biggest number. Pick the scheme whose conditions you can prove without strain. The portal's eligibility checker helps, but your own honest audit matters more: for each scheme you are considering, ask which document of yours proves each condition, and whether that document is current. If any condition has no document behind it, you are about to spend weeks on an application that dies at verification.

If you are	Look first at
Scheduled Caste student	Top Class SC, plus the post-matric scheme for your state
Scheduled Tribe student	National Fellowship and Scholarship for ST Students
OBC, EBC or DNT student	PM YASASVI pre-matric, post-matric or Top Class schemes

If you are	Look first at
Class 12 topper in any board, top 20 percent	CSSS (fresh window; watch the portal)
Top 1 percent in Class 12 choosing B.Sc. or M.Sc.	INSPIRE-SHE (separate portal)
Girl in a technical degree or diploma	AICTE Pragati
Student with 40 percent or more disability	Post-Matric for Students with Disabilities; AICTE Saksham if technical
Ward of a beedi, mine or cine worker	Ministry of Labour ward schemes
Ward of police, CAPF, Assam Rifles or RPF personnel	The three PM Scholarship Schemes
Government school student, Class 9, income under Rs. 3.5 lakh	NMMSS

Part III. The Schemes, One by One

This is the core of the handbook: every central government scholarship on the National Scholarship Portal for the 2026-27 season, plus the two big non-NSP options that students most often miss. Each chapter gives you the eligibility, the money, the deadlines, the documents and the mistakes that cost people that particular scholarship. Read the ones that match you; skim the rest so you know what your friends and siblings qualify for.

Chapter 1

1. National Means-cum-Merit Scholarship (NMMSS)

This is the scholarship most Class 8 and Class 9 families ask about, and for good reason: it pays Rs. 12,000 every year from Class 9 to Class 12, which is up to Rs. 48,000 over four years of school. The Ministry of Education runs it to stop bright students from economically weaker families dropping out after Class 8. For the 2026-27 cycle the application deadline was extended to 30 September 2026, so if you have not applied yet, this is the one to finish first.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	Department of School Education and Literacy, Ministry of Education
Who can get it	Class 9 students in government, government-aided and local body schools
Family income limit	Up to Rs. 3.50 lakh per year
What you get	Rs. 12,000 per year, Classes 9 to 12
Fresh scholarships a year	1 lakh
Selection	State or UT government selection exam
Marks needed	At least 55 percent in Class 7 (5 percent relaxation for SC/ST)
How money arrives	Direct Benefit Transfer through PFMS

Who it is for

- You study in a State Government, government-aided or local body school (private unaided schools are not covered).
- Your parental income is not more than Rs. 3.50 lakh per year.
- You scored at least 55 percent marks or equivalent grade in the Class 7 examination.
- SC and ST students get a 5 percent relaxation, so 50 percent.
- You clear the selection test conducted by your State or UT government.
- Renewal from Class 10 to 12 continues if academic performance conditions are met.

What you get

The amount is Rs. 12,000 per student per year. It goes straight into your bank account by electronic transfer through the Public Financial Management System (PFMS) in DBT mode, so no middleman and no school involvement in the money.

Renewal is not automatic paperwork. It continues from Class 10 to Class 12 based on academic performance, so keep your marks up and complete the renewal form every single year on the portal.

Why this scheme exists

NMMSS exists for a specific moment in a child's life: the jump from Class 8 to Class 9, where dropout risk among economically weaker families is highest. The scale tells you how central it is: as of 31 August 2026, the 2026-27 cycle had already received 79,398 fresh and 1,87,208 renewal applications on the portal. The scheme is run by the Department of School Education and Literacy in the Ministry of Education, and its money moves through PFMS so it cannot be diverted anywhere except the student's account.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Student application on NSP	30 September 2026 (extended from earlier date)
Institute Nodal Officer (L1) verification	15 October 2026
District Nodal Officer (L2) verification	31 October 2026

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Confirm with your school that you are on the selection-test route for this year's state process.
- 2 Complete OTR on scholarships.gov.in with your Aadhaar-linked mobile.
- 3 Find NMMSS in the scheme list, verify the income and marks conditions against your documents, and apply.
- 4 Submit before 30 September 2026 and download the final form with the application ID.
- 5 Tell your school's nodal officer in person and ask for Level 1 verification before 15 October 2026.

Where to go when it stalls

- Your school's Nodal Officer first, then the District Education Office.

- The NSP portal's help section for login and OTR problems.

Renewal, for continuing students

Renewal runs from Class 10 to Class 12 on academic performance. File the renewal form on the same OTR account every year, in the same season, and follow the school verification.

Documents to keep ready

- Class 7 marksheet (proof of the 55 percent score)
- Parental income certificate up to Rs. 3.50 lakh per year
- Aadhaar-linked bank account in the student's name
- School details and the institute's NSP code
- Category certificate if claiming the SC/ST relaxation

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Waiting for another extension. The ministry has already extended the date once; the release does not promise another.
- Filing the form without completing One Time Registration (OTR) first. The application stays incomplete.
- Assuming submission is the end. If your school's nodal officer does not verify by 15 October 2026, the application dies there.
- Applying from a private school. Only government, aided and local body school students are covered.

Questions students ask about this scheme

Do I apply for NMMSS in Class 8 or Class 9?

You apply when you are entering Class 9, after clearing the state's selection process. Renewal students in Classes 10 to 12 file the renewal form each year.

What is the selection test?

Each State or UT government conducts its own selection examination for NMMSS. Ask your school for the state's test schedule; the school is usually the registration point.

Is the money paid monthly?

No. It is an annual scholarship of Rs. 12,000, released by DBT through PFMS once your application clears both verification levels.

What if my school missed the verification deadline?

An application unverified by the institute deadline does not move to disbursement. Contact the school's nodal officer immediately and escalate through the district education office.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 2

2. PM YASASVI Pre-Matric Scholarship (OBC, EBC, DNT)

PM YASASVI is the umbrella scheme of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for OBC, EBC and DNT students, with five sub-schemes under it. The pre-matric piece covers students in Classes 9 and 10 attending government schools, and pays a modest but real Rs. 4,000 per year as academic allowance. Families with income below Rs. 2.5 lakh qualify. If you are OBC, EBC or DNT and in Class 9 or 10 at a government school, this is your entry point into the system.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
Who can get it	OBC, EBC and DNT students in Classes 9 and 10, government schools
Family income limit	Up to Rs. 2.50 lakh per year
What you get	Rs. 4,000 per year academic allowance
How money arrives	DBT, preferably through the Aadhaar Payment Bridge

Who it is for

- You belong to the OBC, EBC or DNT category with a valid certificate.
- You study in Class 9 or Class 10 in a government school.
- Your parents or guardians earn up to Rs. 2.50 lakh per year from all sources.
- You are an Indian national.

What you get

The scholarship is a consolidated academic allowance of Rs. 4,000 per annum. It is paid directly into the student's account through DBT, preferably through the Aadhaar Payment Bridge (AePS), so the money never passes through the school.

Why this scheme exists

PM YASASVI was formed by clubbing the earlier separate OBC, EBC and DNT scholarship schemes and a hostel scheme into one umbrella, so that a family deals with one set of rules instead of five. Its reach is enormous: in 2023-24 alone, Rs. 193.83 crore was allocated for the pre-matric component, benefiting 19.86 lakh students. If your family qualifies, you are one of a very large system that works when the paperwork is right.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Student application on NSP	Per the current NSP listing (pre-matric schemes close 30 September 2026)
Verification stages	Check your exact scheme listing on NSP

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Check with your school that it is a government school covered under the scheme.
- 2 Get your OBC, EBC or DNT certificate and the income certificate ready.
- 3 Complete OTR on the NSP and select the pre-matric YASASVI scheme for your class.
- 4 Submit before the listed deadline and download the final form.
- 5 Follow up for institute verification before the listed date.

Where to go when it stalls

- School Nodal Officer, then the district welfare or backward classes office.
- The scheme page on socialjustice.gov.in carries the guidelines.

Renewal, for continuing students

Renewal into Class 10 repeats the process with the current year's documents. A new income certificate for the current financial year is needed.

Documents to keep ready

- Valid OBC, EBC or DNT category certificate
- Parental income certificate up to Rs. 2.50 lakh per year
- Aadhaar-linked bank account
- School and class details with institute NSP code

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Using a caste certificate in the wrong format. The certificate must show you belong to the OBC, EBC or DNT list for your state.
- Income above the limit. The Rs. 2.50 lakh ceiling counts income from all sources of parents or guardians.

Questions students ask about this scheme

My school is private but aided. Do I qualify?

The pre-matric YASASVI scheme covers government schools. Check with your state education office whether your aided school participates before applying.

Is Rs. 4,000 the total for the whole course?

It is an annual allowance for each year of Classes 9 and 10, paid by DBT into the student's account.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 3

3. PM YASASVI Post-Matric Scholarship (OBC, EBC, DNT)

Once you finish Class 10, the post-matric version of PM YASASVI takes over. It supports post-secondary studies with academic allowances that range from Rs. 5,000 to Rs. 20,000 depending on the category of your course, with the same Rs. 2.50 lakh family income ceiling. The government releases hundreds of crores under this scheme every year and it reaches lakhs of students, but it only reaches the ones who apply correctly on the National Scholarship Portal.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
Who can get it	OBC, EBC and DNT students after Class 10, in post-secondary courses
Family income limit	Up to Rs. 2.50 lakh per year
What you get	Academic allowance between Rs. 5,000 and Rs. 20,000 depending on course group
How money arrives	DBT into the student's bank account

Who it is for

- You belong to OBC, EBC or DNT category with a valid certificate.
- You are studying in a post-secondary or post-matriculation course.
- Family income from all sources is up to Rs. 2.50 lakh per year.
- Your institution is recognised for the scheme.

What you get

The allowance depends on the group your course falls in, running from Rs. 5,000 up to Rs. 20,000. Find your course group in the scheme guidelines on the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment website before you apply, so you know exactly what to expect.

Why this scheme exists

The post-matric component of PM YASASVI is the workhorse of OBC, EBC and DNT student support: in 2023-24, Rs. 988.05 crore was released under it, benefiting 27.97 lakh students. The allowance depends on your course group, so the same scheme pays differently to an ITI student and a degree student. That is by design: the scheme follows the actual cost structure of study levels.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Student application on NSP	31 October 2026
Defective and institute verification	15 November 2026
DNO, SNO or MNO verification	30 November 2026

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Identify your course group in the scheme guidelines to know your allowance.
- 2 Get the fresh OBC NCL certificate for the current financial year if you are OBC.
- 3 Complete OTR, apply under the post-matric YASASVI scheme, and upload the course proof.
- 4 Submit before 31 October 2026 and save the final form.
- 5 Follow up for institute verification before 15 November 2026.

Where to go when it stalls

- College Nodal Officer, then the district welfare office.
- Scheme guidelines are on socialjustice.gov.in.

Renewal, for continuing students

Renewal requires continued enrollment in the course, a current-year OBC NCL certificate where applicable, and timely renewal filing on the same account.

Documents to keep ready

- Valid OBC NCL (non-creamy layer), EBC or DNT certificate for the current financial year
- Income certificate up to Rs. 2.50 lakh
- Course and institution details with NSP institute code
- Previous class marksheet

- Aadhaar-linked bank account

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Submitting an OBC NCL certificate from the previous financial year. It expires every year and is the single most common rejection reason for OBC applicants.
- Assuming the allowance is the same for every course. It varies by course group.

Questions students ask about this scheme

Does it cover tuition fee or just an allowance?

The post-matric YASASVI scheme pays an academic allowance between Rs. 5,000 and Rs. 20,000 depending on your course group; check your course's group in the guidelines.

I am in a diploma course after Class 10. Eligible?

Post-secondary diploma courses are within the scheme's scope if your institution is recognised. Confirm the course group in the guidelines.

Can I hold the SC post-matric scholarship instead if I am OBC?

No. Apply under the scheme matching your certificate. An OBC certificate does not support an SC-scheme application.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 4

4. PM YASASVI Top Class School Education (OBC, EBC, DNT)

This sub-scheme pays for a meritorious OBC, EBC or DNT student to study in a top-performing school from Class 9 to Class 12. The grant covers tuition, hostel and other school charges up to Rs. 75,000 per year for Classes 9 and 10, and up to Rs. 1.25 lakh per year for Classes 11 and 12. At least 30 percent of the scholarship slots are reserved for girls. Selection into the scheme's school stream runs through the YASASVI Entrance Test (YET) conducted by the National Testing Agency.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
Who can get it	OBC, EBC and DNT students in Class 9 to 12 at notified Top Class Schools
Family income limit	Below Rs. 2.50 lakh per year
What you get	Up to Rs. 75,000 per year (Classes 9-10); up to Rs. 1.25 lakh per year (Classes 11-12)
Reserved for girls	At least 30 percent of slots
Selection	School-wise merit; YASASVI Entrance Test (YET) by NTA for entry

Who it is for

- You belong to OBC, EBC or DNT category with a valid certificate.
- You study in a school identified as a Top Class School under the scheme.
- Family income is below Rs. 2.50 lakh per year.
- You are not already receiving the same benefit from another government scheme.

What you get

The grant covers tuition fee, hostel fee and other charges required by the school, subject to a ceiling of Rs. 75,000 per annum for students of Class 9 and 10, and Rs. 1.25 lakh per annum for students of Class 11 and 12. Money moves by DBT and instalments are usually released before 15 August each year.

Why this scheme exists

Top Class School Education was built so that a family's income does not decide the quality of a child's school. The scheme selects high-performing schools that consistently achieve 100 percent pass results in Classes 10 and 12, and pays for eligible OBC, EBC and DNT students to study there. In 2023-24, Rs. 6.55 crore supported 2,602 students in the school stream. At least 30 percent of slots are reserved for girls.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Student application on NSP	31 October 2026
Verification stages	As per NSP scheme listing (15 and 30 November 2026 for verification stages)

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Confirm your school is on the notified Top Class School list.
- 2 Check whether your entry route this year is direct application or the YET conducted by NTA.
- 3 Complete OTR, apply on the NSP with your marks from the previous class final exam.
- 4 Submit before 31 October 2026 and download the final form.
- 5 Follow up for the verification stages with the school.

Where to go when it stalls

- School Nodal Officer and the state welfare department.
- NTA announcements for YET dates; socialjustice.gov.in for guidelines.

Renewal, for continuing students

Continuation in Classes 10, 11 and 12 requires maintaining the scheme's conditions and renewal filing each year.

Documents to keep ready

- Valid OBC, EBC or DNT certificate
- Income certificate below Rs. 2.50 lakh
- Proof of admission or study at a notified Top Class School
- Marks of the final exam of the previous class
- Aadhaar-linked bank account

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Applying from a school that is not on the notified Top Class School list. Check the list first.
- Missing the 30 percent girls reservation. If you are a girl student, mention it correctly in the form.

Questions students ask about this scheme

How do I know if my school is a Top Class School?

The scheme notifies a list of Top Class Schools chosen for consistently achieving 100 percent pass results in Classes 10 and 12. Your school or the state's welfare department holds the list.

What is the YASASVI Entrance Test?

The YET is conducted by the National Testing Agency for selection into the scheme's school stream. Watch NTA announcements if you are seeking fresh entry.

Does the grant cover hostel?

Yes. Tuition, hostel and other school charges are covered within the annual ceilings of Rs. 75,000 for Classes 9-10 and Rs. 1.25 lakh for Classes 11-12.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 5

5. PM YASASVI Top Class College Education (OBC, EBC, DNT)

For OBC, EBC and DNT students who win admission into notified top institutions, this sub-scheme removes the money question completely: full tuition fee, living expenses and educational materials are covered. Students already receiving the same support from another government scheme cannot claim it again. If you have cleared admission into a notified institution, do not assume it is unaffordable before checking this scheme.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
Who can get it	OBC, EBC and DNT students admitted to notified institutions
Family income limit	Up to Rs. 2.50 lakh per year
What you get	Full tuition, living expenses and educational materials
How money arrives	DBT into the student's bank account

Who it is for

- You belong to OBC, EBC or DNT category with a valid certificate.
- You have taken admission in a full-time prescribed course at a notified institution.
- Family income is up to Rs. 2.50 lakh per year.
- You are within the slots allocated to your institution for your course.

What you get

The scheme covers full financial support including tuition, living expenses and books for students at notified top institutions. The exact breakup follows the institution's fee structure within the scheme's limits, and the money reaches you through DBT.

Why this scheme exists

Top Class College Education removes the cost question from premier institutions for OBC, EBC and DNT students: tuition, living expenses and educational materials are all covered. In 2023-24, Rs. 111.18 crore supported 4,762 students in the college stream. If you have an admission letter from a notified institution, this scheme is designed exactly for your situation.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Student application on NSP	31 October 2026
Verification stages	As per NSP scheme listing

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Confirm your institution is notified under the scheme and has slots for your course.
- 2 Gather the category certificate, income certificate and admission proof.
- 3 Complete OTR and apply under the Top Class College scheme on the NSP.
- 4 Submit before 31 October 2026 and save the final form with the application ID.
- 5 Follow up with the college's nodal officer for verification.

Where to go when it stalls

- College Nodal Officer; state welfare department.
- Guidelines on socialjustice.gov.in.

Renewal, for continuing students

Renewal each year of the course, subject to the scheme's academic conditions and timely filing.

Documents to keep ready

- Valid OBC, EBC or DNT certificate
- Income certificate up to Rs. 2.50 lakh
- Admission proof at the notified institution
- Aadhaar-linked bank account

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Assuming your college is covered. Only notified institutions have slots under the scheme.
- Claiming it while holding a similar benefit from another scheme, which is not allowed.

Questions students ask about this scheme

Which institutions are notified?

The scheme maintains a list of notified top institutions with allocated slots. Check the current list on the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment's site before assuming your college is covered.

What does 'full support' include?

Tuition, living expenses and educational materials, within the scheme's limits for your institution and course.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 6

6. Central Sector Scheme of Scholarship (CSSS)

Run by the Ministry of Education, CSSS is one of the most widely used scholarships for Class 12 pass-outs entering regular undergraduate programmes. The bar is marks plus means: you need to be above the 80th percentile of successful candidates in your board's Class 12 examination, and your family income must be under Rs. 8 lakh per year. The award runs at Rs. 10,000 to Rs. 20,000 per year. One thing to know right now: for the 2026-27 session the portal has been showing the renewal window (closing 30 September 2026) while the fresh application window had not opened as of early September. If you are a new Class 12 pass-out, keep your documents ready and watch the portal instead of trusting social media dates.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	Ministry of Education, via the National Scholarship Portal
Who can get it	Class 12 pass-outs in the top 20 percent of their board, entering regular UG courses
Family income limit	Under Rs. 8 lakh per year
What you get	Rs. 10,000 to Rs. 20,000 per year
Covers	Regular, full-time undergraduate and postgraduate programmes

Who it is for

- You scored above the 80th percentile of successful candidates in your board's Class 12 exam.
- You are enrolled in a regular, full-time course (not distance or correspondence).
- Family income is under Rs. 8 lakh per annum.
- You are not receiving another scholarship that prohibits it under the scheme rules.

What you get

The award is Rs. 10,000 per year for the undergraduate years and Rs. 20,000 per year at the higher levels, per the current scheme summary. Payment is by DBT into your bank account. Renewal each year requires maintaining the academic performance the scheme prescribes and filling the renewal form on time.

Why this scheme exists

CSSS is the Ministry of Education's flagship for college students, run under the PM-USP umbrella. Its design is deliberately wide: it is not category-based, so any board topper within the income limit qualifies regardless of community. The two-clock reality of 2026-27, renewals open until 30 September while the fresh window had not opened as of early September, is a reminder to watch the portal rather than the news.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Renewal applications (2026-27)	30 September 2026
Renewal institute verification	15 October 2026
Renewal DNO, SNO or MNO verification	30 October 2026
Fresh applications	Not yet opened as of early September 2026; watch the official portal

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 If renewing: complete the renewal form before 30 September 2026 with your previous application details.
- 2 If fresh: complete OTR now, keep documents ready, and watch the portal for the fresh window.
- 3 Verify your percentile position against the board's published cutoff.
- 4 Apply, submit, and download the final form.
- 5 Follow up for institute verification within the window that applies to your application type.

Where to go when it stalls

- College scholarship cell and Nodal Officer.
- NSP portal help section for window and status questions.

Renewal, for continuing students

Renewal applications for 2026-27 close 30 September 2026, with institute verification by 15 October and nodal verification by 30 October. Academic performance conditions apply each year.

Documents to keep ready

- Class 12 marksheet showing the percentile position
- Income certificate under Rs. 8 lakh
- Admission proof for a regular course
- Aadhaar-linked bank account
- Previous year's scholarship details for renewal

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Relying on YouTube videos for the fresh application date. The portal is the only source; fresh windows open without much notice.
- Applying while in a distance-education programme. CSSS covers regular courses only.
- Letting income cross the limit mid-course. Renewal re-checks eligibility conditions.

Questions students ask about this scheme

How do I know if I am in the top 20 percent of my board?

Boards publish percentile cutoffs with results. Above the 80th percentile of successful candidates is the eligibility line; the official notification carries the exact formulation.

I am in the second year of my degree and never applied. Can I start now?

CSSS supports students from the first year onward, but you must have entered through a fresh window. A late start is generally not possible; watch for the fresh window in the year you qualify.

What does renewal require?

Timely renewal filing each year, continued enrollment in a regular course, meeting the academic performance condition, and income still under the limit.

Is distance education covered?

No. CSSS covers regular, full-time courses only.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 7

7. Top Class Education for SC Students

The Central Sector Scheme of Top Class Education in Schools supports Scheduled Caste students admitted to notified premier institutions. Where most scholarships pay a fixed allowance, this one aims at full coverage: tuition plus an annual allowance of up to Rs. 86,000 for living expenses and books according to the current scheme listing. If you are an SC student holding an admission letter from a notified institution, this scheme exists precisely so that you do not have to give that seat up for money reasons.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
Who can get it	SC students admitted to notified institutions
What you get	Full tuition plus annual allowance of up to Rs. 86,000 (living and books)
How money arrives	DBT into the student's bank account

Who it is for

- You belong to the Scheduled Caste category with a valid certificate.
- You have secured admission to a notified institution under the scheme.
- You meet the general selection criteria of the institution.
- You are not availing the same benefit from another central scheme.

What you get

The scheme pays tuition and academic fees directly and supports living and books through an allowance of up to Rs. 86,000 according to the current listing. Disbursement is through DBT, so the money lands in your account rather than anyone else's.

Why this scheme exists

The Top Class Education scheme for SC students aims at notified premier institutions, covering tuition and supporting living and books with an allowance of up to Rs. 86,000 according to the current listing. It exists so that an admission earned on merit is never surrendered for money reasons.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Student application on NSP	31 October 2026
Verification stages	15 November 2026 (defective and institute); 30 November 2026 (nodal)

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Confirm your institution is notified under the scheme.
- 2 Gather the SC certificate, admission proof and fee structure.
- 3 Complete OTR and apply on the NSP before 31 October 2026.
- 4 Download the final form and meet the nodal officer.
- 5 Track verification through 15 and 30 November 2026.

Where to go when it stalls

- College Nodal Officer; state social welfare department.
- Guidelines on socialjustice.gov.in.

Renewal, for continuing students

Renewal each academic year of the course, subject to the scheme's conditions and the institution's continuation of your enrollment.

Documents to keep ready

- Valid SC certificate
- Admission proof from the notified institution
- Institution fee structure
- Aadhaar-linked bank account

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Not confirming the institution is notified under the scheme before applying.
- Uploading a category certificate issued by an authority not competent for SC certification.

Questions students ask about this scheme

What counts as a notified institution?

Premier institutions notified under the scheme, with slots allocated per course. The Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment publishes the list.

Can I combine it with a state SC scholarship?

You cannot claim the same benefit twice from two schemes. Check both schemes' rules on other awards before assuming a combination.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 8

8. National Fellowship and Scholarship for ST Students (Higher Education)

Run by the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, this scheme supports Scheduled Tribe students in higher education, with scholarship support that the current NSP listing puts at Rs. 2.50 lakh in tuition plus allowances. ST students at notified institutions are the core audience. Because tribal-area document infrastructure can be slower, start this one earliest of all your applications.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	Ministry of Tribal Affairs
Who can get it	ST students in higher education at notified institutions
What you get	Up to Rs. 2.50 lakh tuition plus allowances per the current listing
How money arrives	DBT into the student's bank account

Who it is for

- You belong to the Scheduled Tribe category with a valid certificate.
- You are enrolled in higher education covered by the scheme.
- You meet the course-level and institution conditions in the scheme guidelines.

What you get

Support runs up to Rs. 2.50 lakh in tuition plus allowances according to the current NSP listing. Payment is by DBT. Check the exact components for your course level in the scheme guidelines before applying.

Why this scheme exists

Run by the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, this scheme supports ST students through higher education at notified institutions, with tuition support up to Rs. 2.50 lakh plus allowances in the current listing. Tribal-area certificate infrastructure can move slowly, which is why the practical advice for this scheme is always: start the certificate first, apply second.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Student application on NSP	31 October 2026
Verification stages	15 November 2026 (defective and institute); 30 November 2026 (nodal)

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Start or renew the ST certificate with the competent revenue authority.
- 2 Confirm your institution is notified under the scheme.
- 3 Complete OTR and apply on the NSP before 31 October 2026.
- 4 Download the final form, meet the nodal officer.
- 5 Track verification through 15 and 30 November 2026.

Where to go when it stalls

- College Nodal Officer; tribal welfare department of your state.
- Scheme details on tribal.nic.in.

Renewal, for continuing students

Renewal each year with continued enrollment; keep the ST certificate and enrollment proof current.

Documents to keep ready

- Valid ST certificate
- Enrollment proof at the institution
- Course and fee details
- Aadhaar-linked bank account

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Delaying the ST certificate renewal or issue. Apply for it now, not after the deadline pressure builds.

Questions students ask about this scheme

Where do I get an ST certificate from?

The competent revenue authority in your state issues ST certificates. Tribal area students should apply well before the season starts, because verification there can take longer.

Does it cover private colleges?

The scheme covers notified institutions. A private college not notified under the scheme is not covered, whatever its ranking.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 9

9. Post-Matric Scholarship for Students with Disabilities

This scheme supports students with 40 percent or more benchmark disability in post-matric and post-secondary courses. The current NSP listing shows fee support of up to Rs. 1.40 lakh plus allowances. A disability certificate from a competent medical authority is the key document, and assistive device and hostel needs are also supported under the scheme.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities
Who can get it	Students with 40 percent or more benchmark disability
What you get	Fee support up to Rs. 1.40 lakh plus allowances
How money arrives	DBT into the student's bank account

Who it is for

- You have a benchmark disability of 40 percent or more, certified by a competent authority.
- You are pursuing a post-matric or post-secondary course.
- You meet the income condition, if any, prescribed in the scheme guidelines.

What you get

The current listing shows support of up to Rs. 1.40 lakh toward fees along with allowances. Components such as hostel, books and assistive devices follow the scheme guidelines for your course level, and everything is paid by DBT.

Why this scheme exists

This scheme, run by the Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities, supports students with 40 percent or more benchmark disability through post-matric study, with fee support up to Rs. 1.40 lakh plus allowances in the current listing. Its applications for 2026-27 opened on 25 July 2026 and close 30 September 2026, an earlier window than most schemes, which catches students who assume every deadline is 31 October.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Student application on NSP	30 September 2026 (applications opened 25 July 2026)
Defective and institute verification	15 October 2026
Nodal verification	31 October 2026

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Get the disability certificate stating the percentage from the designated medical authority.
- 2 Complete OTR on the NSP.
- 3 Apply under the post-matric disability scheme before 30 September 2026.
- 4 Download the final form and inform the nodal officer.
- 5 Track verification through mid and end October 2026.

Where to go when it stalls

- College Nodal Officer; the scheme's department through the portal.
- NSP help section for certificate-format questions.

Renewal, for continuing students

Renewal each year of post-matric study with a current disability certificate on record.

Documents to keep ready

- Disability certificate showing 40 percent or more benchmark disability
- Course and institution details
- Income proof if required by the scheme guidelines
- Aadhaar-linked bank account

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- A disability certificate that does not state the percentage. The portal needs the benchmark number.

Questions students ask about this scheme

Who can issue the disability certificate?

A designated medical authority under the Rights of Persons with Disabilities framework. The certificate must state the percentage of disability.

Are assistive devices covered?

The scheme supports study-related components under its guidelines; the fee support of up to Rs. 1.40 lakh is the headline figure in the current listing.

I have 39 percent disability. Any chance?

No. The benchmark is 40 percent or more. If your condition is progressive, get reassessed by the competent authority.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 10

10. Scholarships for Wards of Beedi, Cine, IOMC and LSDM Workers

The Ministry of Labour and Employment runs scholarships for the children of workers in some of the country's hardest occupations: beedi workers, cine workers, and workers in iron ore, manganese and chrome (IOMC) mines and limestone and dolomite (LSDM) mines. Both pre-matric and post-matric versions exist. The post-matric listing shows support up to Rs. 25,000 per annum. The proof that matters here is the parent's occupation certificate from the designated authority.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	Ministry of Labour and Employment
Who can get it	Children of beedi, cine, IOMC and LSDM workers
What you get	Up to Rs. 25,000 per annum (post-matric listing)
Levels covered	Pre-matric and post-matric
How money arrives	DBT into the student's bank account

Who it is for

- Your parent is a beedi, cine, IOMC or LSDM worker as defined by the scheme.
- You are studying at the pre-matric or post-matric level covered by the specific scheme.
- You meet the income condition in the scheme guidelines.

What you get

The post-matric scheme listing shows support of up to Rs. 25,000 per annum. Pre-matric amounts are lower and follow the scheme guidelines. Payment is by DBT into the student's account.

Why this scheme exists

The Ministry of Labour and Education's welfare funds for beedi workers, cine workers, and IOMC and LSDM mine workers fund scholarships for their children, both pre-matric and post-matric. The distinguishing document is occupational: proof that the parent is an eligible worker, issued by the designated authority. The pre-matric version closes 30 September 2026 and the post-matric 31 October 2026, so a family with two children in different stages may face two different deadlines.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Pre-matric applications	30 September 2026
Post-matric applications	31 October 2026
Verification stages	Per NSP listing (mid-October to end-November 2026)

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Obtain the parent's occupation certificate from the designated authority.
- 2 Complete OTR on the NSP.
- 3 Apply under the correct level (pre-matric or post-matric) before its deadline.
- 4 Download the final form and inform the school or college nodal officer.
- 5 Track verification through the listed dates.

Where to go when it stalls

- School or college Nodal Officer; the regional welfare commissioner's office for occupation proof questions.

Renewal, for continuing students

Renewal requires the parent's continued eligible employment proof and timely renewal filing each year.

Documents to keep ready

- Parent's occupation certificate from the designated authority
- Wage or employment proof of the parent
- School or college details
- Aadhaar-linked bank account

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- An occupation certificate from the wrong authority. Check the scheme guidelines for who can certify.

Questions students ask about this scheme

Who certifies that my father is a beedi worker?

The designated authority for the scheme, typically through the regional welfare commissioner's office. Ask through the trade union or the district labour office if unsure.

My mother is the mine worker. Does it count?

Yes, either parent's eligible employment can support the application, subject to the scheme's definition of the worker.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 11

11. The Prime Minister's Scholarship Schemes (PMSS)

Three separate PM Scholarship Schemes on the NSP support the wards of uniformed service families: wards of States and UTs police personnel martyred in terror or Naxal attacks; wards of Central Armed Police Forces and Assam Rifles personnel; and wards of RPF and RPSF personnel. The current listings put the support at Rs. 3,000 per month. Run by the Ministry of Home Affairs and the Railway Board respectively, these scholarships honour service by supporting the education of the families left behind or still serving.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs them	Ministry of Home Affairs (WARB) and Railway Board
Who can get them	Wards of martyred police personnel, CAPF and Assam Rifles personnel, and RPF/RPSF personnel
What you get	Rs. 3,000 per month as per current listings
How money arrives	DBT into the student's bank account

Who it is for

- Your parent served in the eligible force (State or UT police martyred in terror or Naxal attacks, CAPF and Assam Rifles, or RPF and RPSF).
- You meet the course-level conditions prescribed for the specific scheme.
- You apply with the service details of the parent in the prescribed proof.

What you get

The current NSP listings show Rs. 3,000 per month for these schemes. Because they are monthly awards, they continue through the course subject to renewal conditions, paid by DBT.

Why this scheme exists

The Prime Minister's Scholarship Schemes are the nation's specific commitment to the wards of those who served in uniform: State and UT police personnel martyred in terror or Naxal attacks, Central Armed Police Forces and Assam Rifles personnel, and RPF and RPSF personnel. All three run on the NSP for 2026-27 with applications open until 31 October 2026, at Rs. 3,000 per month in the current listings.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Student application on NSP	31 October 2026
Defective and institute verification	15 November 2026
DNO, SNO or MNO verification	30 November 2026

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Identify which of the three schemes matches your parent's service.
- 2 Obtain the service or martyrdom proof in the prescribed form from the force's records office.
- 3 Complete OTR on the NSP.
- 4 Apply under the correct PMSS listing before 31 October 2026.
- 5 Download the final form and follow up for verification before 15 November 2026.

Where to go when it stalls

- The force's records office for service proof.
- School or college Nodal Officer; WARB through the portal for scheme questions.

Renewal, for continuing students

The monthly award continues subject to the scheme's renewal conditions; file renewal on the same account.

Documents to keep ready

- Parent's service or martyrdom proof
- Course and institution details
- Aadhaar-linked bank account

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Applying under the wrong force's scheme. The three schemes have different parent-service conditions.

Questions students ask about this scheme

My father served in the army, not CAPF. Which scheme?

None of these three. Army welfare runs through separate ex-servicemen channels, not the NSP PMSS listings. Check the Kendriya Sainik Board route.

Martyrdom proof: what document?

The official martyrdom or service record issued by the force, in the format the scheme prescribes. The force's records office is the place to obtain it.

Is PMSS for professional courses only?

The schemes prescribe course-level conditions; check the current notification for your scheme before applying.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 12

12. PM-USP Special Scholarship Scheme for Jammu, Kashmir and Ladakh

This scheme supports students with domicile of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh studying outside the region, with the current listing showing support up to Rs. 3.00 lakh per annum for medical courses and corresponding amounts for other streams. For the 2026-27 session the renewal window is open and closes 30 September 2026.

Fresh-window dates for the year should be confirmed on the portal.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	All India Council for Technical Education, under PM-USP
Who can get it	Students with Jammu and Kashmir or Ladakh domicile
What you get	Up to Rs. 3.00 lakh per annum for medical courses as per the current listing
How money arrives	DBT into the student's bank account

Who it is for

- You hold domicile of Jammu and Kashmir or Ladakh.
- You are studying in an eligible course outside the region as per the scheme rules.
- You meet the academic conditions for your course level.

What you get

The current listing shows support up to Rs. 3.00 lakh per annum for medical courses, with corresponding amounts for other streams. Payment is by DBT.

Why this scheme exists

The PM-USP Special Scholarship Scheme exists so that students with Jammu and Kashmir or Ladakh domicile can pursue studies outside the region without the cost barrier, with support reaching up to Rs. 3.00 lakh per annum for medical courses in the current listing. It runs through AICTE under the PM-USP umbrella. For 2026-27, the renewal window closes 30 September 2026 with fresh dates announced separately.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Renewal applications (2026-27)	30 September 2026
Renewal institute verification	15 October 2026
Renewal nodal verification	30 October 2026

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Keep your domicile certificate current.
- 2 Renewal students: file before 30 September 2026.
- 3 Fresh students: complete OTR and watch the portal for the fresh window.
- 4 Download the final form and meet the institution's nodal officer.
- 5 Track verification through the listed dates.

Where to go when it stalls

- College Nodal Officer; AICTE through its official site for scheme questions.

Renewal, for continuing students

Renewal for 2026-27 closes 30 September 2026, with verification stages in October. File before the fresh-window crowd, not with it.

Documents to keep ready

- Domicile certificate of Jammu and Kashmir or Ladakh
- Admission proof at the institution outside the region
- Aadhaar-linked bank account

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Missing the 30 September renewal deadline. The fresh window follows its own schedule, so renewal students must not wait for it.

Questions students ask about this scheme

I am from Ladakh studying in Delhi. Fresh or renewal?

If you did not hold the scholarship last year, you are fresh and must wait for the fresh window; if you held it, file renewal before 30 September 2026.

What is PM-USP?

Pradhan Mantri Uchchatar Shiksha Protsahan, the umbrella programme under which the Jammu and Kashmir special scholarship and CSSS run.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 13

13. AICTE Pragati Scholarship for Girl Students

AICTE's Pragati scheme supports girl students in technical education, both degree and diploma programmes, with support of up to Rs. 50,000 per annum toward tuition and incidentals. Two separate listings exist on the NSP, one for degree and one for diploma students, and both close 31 October 2026. If you are a girl student in an engineering degree or diploma course, check both listings and apply to the one matching your course.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE)
Who can get it	Girl students in technical degree or diploma programmes
What you get	Up to Rs. 50,000 per annum toward tuition and incidentals
Listings on NSP	Two: technical degree and technical diploma
How money arrives	DBT into the student's bank account

Who it is for

- You are a girl student admitted to a technical degree or diploma course.
- You are in the year of the course covered by the scheme guidelines.
- Family income is within the limit prescribed in the guidelines.
- You are not availing another scholarship for the same purpose simultaneously.

What you get

The scheme provides up to Rs. 50,000 per annum for tuition fees, purchase of books, equipment and other incidentals, per the current listing. It is paid by DBT.

Why this scheme exists

AICTE's Pragati scheme targets a stubborn gap in technical education: the participation and continuation of girl students in degree and diploma programmes. With support of up to Rs. 50,000 per annum and two separate NSP listings for degree and diploma students, it is one of the most applied-to AICTE schemes. Both listings close 31 October 2026.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Student application on NSP	31 October 2026
Defective and institute verification	15 November 2026
DNO, SNO or MNO verification	30 November 2026

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Pick the listing matching your course: technical degree or technical diploma.
- 2 Keep admission proof and income documents ready per the guidelines.
- 3 Complete OTR on the NSP.
- 4 Apply before 31 October 2026 and download the final form.
- 5 Follow up for verification before 15 November 2026.

Where to go when it stalls

- College Nodal Officer; AICTE through its official site for scheme questions.

Renewal, for continuing students

Renewal for continuing years of the degree or diploma per the scheme guidelines, on the same account.

Documents to keep ready

- Admission proof for the technical degree or diploma course
- Income proof per the scheme guidelines
- Aadhaar-linked bank account

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Applying to both the degree and diploma listings. Choose the one matching your actual course.

Questions students ask about this scheme

I am in the second year of my diploma. Can I apply?

Pragati supports girl students in technical courses per the scheme guidelines; check the current notification's year-of-study condition on the portal listing.

Does Rs. 50,000 go to my college?

No. It is paid by DBT to you, toward tuition, books, equipment and incidentals.

Can I hold Pragati and a state scholarship together?

Only if neither scheme prohibits it. Declare the other award; hiding it risks both.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 14

14. AICTE Saksham Scholarship for Specially Abled Students

Saksham is Pragati's counterpart for specially abled students in technical education. It supports degree and diploma students with 40 percent or more disability with up to Rs. 50,000 per annum, per the current listing. The disability certificate with the percentage stated is the document the verification stage checks hardest, so get it right the first time.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE)
Who can get it	Specially abled students with 40 percent or more disability, in technical programmes
What you get	Up to Rs. 50,000 per annum
How money arrives	DBT into the student's bank account

Who it is for

- You have a benchmark disability of 40 percent or more with a valid certificate.
- You are admitted to a technical degree or diploma programme.
- You meet the family income and other conditions in the guidelines.

What you get

The current listing shows Rs. 50,000 per annum toward tuition, books and incidentals, paid by DBT.

Why this scheme exists

Saksham is AICTE's scholarship for specially abled students in technical degree and diploma programmes, at Rs. 50,000 per annum in the current listing. Its defining document is the disability certificate with the percentage stated, and its most common failure is a certificate that names the condition but not the percentage.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Student application on NSP	31 October 2026
Defective and institute verification	15 November 2026
DNO, SNO or MNO verification	30 November 2026

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Get the disability certificate with the percentage from the designated authority.
- 2 Complete OTR on the NSP.
- 3 Apply before 31 October 2026 and download the final form.
- 4 Inform the college nodal officer.
- 5 Track verification through 15 and 30 November 2026.

Where to go when it stalls

- College Nodal Officer; AICTE through its official site for scheme questions.

Renewal, for continuing students

Renewal for continuing years per the scheme guidelines, with the disability certificate current.

Documents to keep ready

- Disability certificate showing 40 percent or more
- Admission proof for the technical programme
- Aadhaar-linked bank account

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- A disability certificate without the percentage clearly stated.

Questions students ask about this scheme

My disability is 60 percent but not visible. Eligible?

Yes. The benchmark is the certified percentage, not the visibility of the condition.

Is there an income limit?

Follow the current scheme guidelines on the portal listing for the income condition.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 15

15. AICTE Swanath Scholarship Scheme

Swanath supports students in technical education who lost their parents to COVID-19, or who face equivalent critical family situations such as orphans or single-parent hardship, with Rs. 50,000 per annum per the current listing. The documentation is sensitive and specific: death certificates, orphanage or competent-authority declarations, depending on the category you fall in.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE)
Who can get it	Students in technical programmes who are orphans or from critical family situations
What you get	Rs. 50,000 per annum
How money arrives	DBT into the student's bank account

Who it is for

- You are studying in a technical degree or diploma programme.
- You qualify under the categories defined by the scheme, such as wards who lost parents to COVID-19 or students from orphanages.
- You hold the proof issued by the competent authority for your category.

What you get

The current listing shows Rs. 50,000 per annum for tuition, books and incidentals, paid by DBT.

Why this scheme exists

AICTE's Swanath scheme supports technical students from the hardest family situations, including wards who lost parents to COVID-19, at Rs. 50,000 per annum in the current listing. It is a small scheme relative to the others, and its documentation burden is the heaviest per applicant, because each qualifying category needs its specific proof from a competent authority.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Student application on NSP	31 October 2026
Verification stages	15 and 30 November 2026

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Identify your qualifying category and its prescribed proof.
- 2 Collect the proof document from the competent authority.
- 3 Complete OTR on the NSP.
- 4 Apply before 31 October 2026 and download the final form.
- 5 Follow up for verification through 15 November 2026.

Where to go when it stalls

- College Nodal Officer; AICTE through its official site for category-proof questions.

Renewal, for continuing students

Renewal per the scheme guidelines for continuing years of the technical programme.

Documents to keep ready

- Proof for the qualifying category (death certificate, orphanage certificate or competent authority declaration)
- Admission proof for the technical programme
- Aadhaar-linked bank account

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Incomplete category proof. Each qualifying category has a specific document; the general one will not do.

Questions students ask about this scheme

Who counts as an orphan for Swanath?

The scheme's categories, including wards who lost parents to COVID-19 and students from orphanages, each with prescribed proof. Read the notification's category list carefully.

Is a death certificate enough for the COVID-19 category?

The notification prescribes the exact document set, which can include the death certificate and a competent authority declaration. Check it before uploading.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 16

16. NEC Merit Scholarship for North Eastern Region Students

The North Eastern Council runs a merit scholarship for students of the eight north-eastern states. The current listing shows amounts up to Rs. 30,000 per annum at the PhD level with lower amounts for lower course levels, and this cycle it is open for renewal only. If you are from the region and held this scholarship last year, the renewal is your job to file, nobody else's.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	North Eastern Council, Ministry of DoNER
Who can get it	Students of the North Eastern Region
What you get	Up to Rs. 30,000 per annum at PhD level per the current listing
Status (2026-27)	Open for renewal

Who it is for

- You are a resident of one of the north-eastern states.
- You are studying at a course level covered by the scheme.
- For 2026-27, you are a continuing (renewal) beneficiary.

What you get

Amounts vary by course level, reaching up to Rs. 30,000 per annum for PhD-level study per the current listing. Payment is by DBT.

Why this scheme exists

The North Eastern Council's merit scholarship supports students of the eight north-eastern states across course levels, with the current listing showing amounts up to Rs. 30,000 per annum at PhD level and the 2026-27 cycle open for renewal only. For students of the region, this scheme stacks with Ishan Uday, making the portal listing a twice-a-week habit during the season.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Student application on NSP	31 October 2026 (renewal)
Verification stages	15 and 30 November 2026

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Renewal students: file the renewal form before 31 October 2026.
- 2 Keep your residence proof for the north-eastern state current.
- 3 Complete OTR on the NSP.
- 4 Download the final form and meet the nodal officer.
- 5 Track verification through 15 and 30 November 2026.

Where to go when it stalls

- College Nodal Officer; the NEC scheme listing through the portal.

Renewal, for continuing students

The 2026-27 cycle is renewal-only: file before 31 October 2026 on your existing account.

Documents to keep ready

- Residence proof for a north-eastern state
- Course level and institution details
- Aadhaar-linked bank account

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Assuming the college renews it for you. Renewal is filed by the student on the portal.

Questions students ask about this scheme

I am from Assam, first year of college. Can I apply fresh?

The 2026-27 listing is open for renewal only. Fresh openings, when announced, appear on the portal listing first.

Which states does NEC cover?

The eight north-eastern states: Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Sikkim and Tripura.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 17

17. UGC Schemes: National PG Scholarship and Ishan Uday

Two University Grants Commission schemes were listed for the 2026-27 session but had not opened for applications as of early September 2026. The National Scholarship for Post Graduate Studies supports first-year postgraduate students at Rs. 15,000 per month per the listing. Ishan Uday supports students of the North Eastern Region in undergraduate and postgraduate courses at Rs. 8,000 per month. Watch the NSP portal for their opening dates; when they open, the windows are short.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs them	University Grants Commission (UGC)
National PG Scholarship	First PG degree students, Rs. 15,000 per month per listing
Ishan Uday	North Eastern Region UG and PG students, Rs. 8,000 per month per listing
Status (2026-27)	Not yet opened as of early September 2026

Who it is for

- National PG Scholarship: you are in your first postgraduate degree year at a recognised institution.
- Ishan Uday: you are a student of the North Eastern Region in an undergraduate or postgraduate course.
- Both: you meet the income and academic conditions in the scheme guidelines once published.

What you get

The listings show Rs. 15,000 per month for the National PG Scholarship and Rs. 8,000 per month for Ishan Uday. Both pay by DBT when the windows open.

Why this scheme exists

The UGC's National Scholarship for Post Graduate Studies and the Ishan Uday scholarship for North Eastern Region students had not opened for 2026-27 as of early September 2026. The listings show Rs. 15,000 per month and Rs. 8,000 per month respectively. These schemes have a habit of opening late and closing fast, which is why the preparation now matters more than the calendar.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Application window	To be announced on the NSP portal
What to do now	Complete OTR and keep documents ready

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Complete OTR now so that you can apply the day the window opens.
- 2 Keep PG admission proof or the region residence proof ready.
- 3 Watch the NSP scheme listing weekly for the opening announcement.
- 4 Apply immediately when the window opens; do not wait for the 'last date'.

Where to go when it stalls

- College Nodal Officer; UGC through its official site for scheme questions.

Documents to keep ready

- PG admission proof for National PG Scholarship
- North Eastern Region residence proof for Ishan Uday
- Aadhaar-linked bank account

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Relying on unofficial dates. These schemes open late and close fast; only the portal listing counts.

Questions students ask about this scheme

When will they open?

Not announced as of early September 2026. The portal listing is the only reliable source; windows for these schemes are historically short.

I am doing an MA. Which one is mine?

The National Scholarship for Post Graduate Studies, once it opens, for first-year PG students.

I am from Shillong doing a BA. Mine?

Ishan Uday, once it opens, for North Eastern Region undergraduate students.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 18

18. INSPIRE Scholarship for Higher Education (SHE)

The INSPIRE-SHE is the biggest scholarship most science students have never applied to. The Department of Science and Technology awards 12,000 scholarships every year, each worth Rs. 80,000 per annum, to students who take up basic and natural sciences at the bachelor or master level. It is NOT on the NSP portal; it runs on its own portal, online-inspire.gov.in, and opens against a call announcement, usually after Class 12 results. If you are a top-1-percent student choosing between engineering and a B.Sc., this scholarship changes that calculation.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	Department of Science and Technology, Ministry of Science and Technology
Who can get it	Top 1-percent Class 12 students, and JEE or NEET top-10,000 rankers, choosing basic and natural sciences
What you get	Rs. 80,000 per annum (Rs. 60,000 scholarship plus Rs. 20,000 mentorship grant)
Number of scholarships	12,000 every year
Where to apply	online-inspire.gov.in (not the NSP portal)
Duration	Up to five years or course completion, whichever is earlier

Who it is for

- You are within the top 1 percent of Class 12 results of any State or Central board, AND pursuing basic or natural sciences at B.Sc., B.S., B.Sc. with Research, Int. M.Sc. or M.S. level; or
- You hold a rank within the top 10,000 in the JEE or NEET (AIPMT) and are now pursuing a basic or natural science course; or
- You are studying an integrated M.S. in natural sciences at IISERs, NISER, the Department of Atomic Energy Centre for Basic Sciences at the University of Mumbai, or Visva-Bharati; or
- You were selected under KVPY; or you are an NTSE scholar, JBNSTS scholar or International Olympiad medallist pursuing natural sciences.

- Your course is in one of the 18 supported subjects: Physics, Chemistry, Mathematics, Biology, Statistics, Geology, Astrophysics, Astronomy, Electronics, Botany, Zoology, Biochemistry, Anthropology, Microbiology, Geophysics, Geochemistry, Atmospheric Sciences or Oceanic Sciences.
- You are in the age group of 17 to 22 years.

What you get

Each scholar receives Rs. 5,000 per month, totaling Rs. 60,000 per year. On top of that, every SHE scholar undertakes a summer research project under an active researcher at a recognised research centre in India, and receives a mentorship grant of Rs. 20,000 per year for it. You must submit the project report and the mentor's certificate after the project.

The support runs for a maximum of five years starting from the first year of the course, and continues subject to good academic performance and the institution head's recommendation.

Why this scheme exists

INSPIRE was approved in November 2008 and launched by the Prime Minister on 13 December 2008, with the Scholarship for Higher Education as its student-facing component. From the SHE-2017 batch onward, 12,000 scholarships of Rs. 80,000 each are announced annually for basic and natural sciences. The DST's own description is worth remembering: the mentorship attached to every scholar is as much the point as the money.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
Application mode	Against call announcements on the INSPIRE portal
What to do now	Watch online-inspire.gov.in if you have just entered a basic sciences course

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Check the call announcement on online-inspire.gov.in after your Class 12 results and enrolment.
- 2 Verify your course is in one of the 18 supported subjects.
- 3 Register on the INSPIRE portal and apply against the call, uploading the prescribed documents.
- 4 Track the application on the INSPIRE portal, not the NSP.
- 5 Once selected, complete the summer research project each year and submit the report and mentor certificate.

Where to go when it stalls

- The INSPIRE portal's own help channels.
- Your institution's endorsement, where the call requires it.

Renewal, for continuing students

Continuation is annual, for up to five years from the first year of the course, subject to good academic performance, the head of institution's recommendation, and the summer research project report and mentor certificate each year.

Documents to keep ready

- Class 12 marksheet or JEE or NEET rank proof
- Admission proof into a qualifying basic sciences course
- Aadhaar-linked bank account
- Endorsement from the institution as required by the call

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Applying for a professional course. Biotechnology, computer science, engineering, medicine, psychology, economics, geography, home science, bioinformatics and distance-mode courses are NOT supported.
- Looking for it on the NSP portal. INSPIRE has its own portal and its own calendar.
- Skipping the summer research project. The mentorship grant and continuation depend on it.

Questions students ask about this scheme**I am in my second year of B.Sc. Can I apply?**

No. Only candidates who completed Class 12 in the year of the call and enrolled in a qualifying course in the same year can apply.

My subject is biotechnology. Eligible?

No. The 18 supported subjects are basic and natural sciences only. Biotechnology, computer science, bioinformatics and professional courses are not supported.

What is the summer project requirement?

Every SHE scholar must undertake a summer research project under an active researcher at a recognised research centre, submit the report, and get the mentor's certificate. The Rs. 20,000 mentorship grant pays for it.

Where do I track my application?

On online-inspire.gov.in. INSPIRE is not on the NSP portal and never has been.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Chapter 19

19. Reliance Foundation Undergraduate Scholarships

Among private programmes, the Reliance Foundation Undergraduate Scholarship is the one worth your application time. It awards 5,000 scholarships every year, worth up to Rs. 2 lakh across the degree, to first-year undergraduate students in any stream with at least 60 percent in Class 12 and household income under Rs. 15 lakh per year, with preference to families below Rs. 2.5 lakh. Roughly 80 percent of the amount is disbursed upfront each year for tuition. There is no application fee at any stage, and the 2026-27 cycle is open.

At a glance

Field	Details
Who runs it	Reliance Foundation (private)
Who can get it	First-year UG students in any stream with 60 percent or more in Class 12
Income limit	Household income under Rs. 15 lakh per year, preference below Rs. 2.5 lakh
What you get	Up to Rs. 2 lakh over the degree
Selection	Merit-cum-means plus a mandatory online aptitude test
Where to apply	scholarships.reliancefoundation.org
Application fee	None, at any stage

Who it is for

- You are a resident Indian citizen.
- You passed Class 12 with a minimum of 60 percent marks.
- You are enrolled in the first year of a regular, full-time undergraduate degree in any stream.
- Your household income is under Rs. 15 lakh per annum (preference to below Rs. 2.5 lakh).
- You are in your first year only; students beyond first year are not eligible.

What you get

The scholarship is worth up to Rs. 2 lakh over the full duration of the degree. About 80 percent is disbursed upfront each year toward tuition, and the remaining 20 percent can support professional development activities such as conferences.

Why this scheme exists

The Reliance Foundation Undergraduate Scholarship is among India's largest privately funded scholarship programmes, awarding 5,000 undergraduate scholarships every year with support of up to Rs. 2 lakh across the degree. Roughly 80 percent of each year's amount is disbursed upfront for tuition, and the remaining 20 percent supports professional development. The 2026-27 cycle is open, and the process charges no fee at any stage.

2026-27 deadlines

Stage	Date
2026-27 cycle	Open as of this handbook's date; check the portal for the closing date
Selection stage	Online aptitude test is mandatory

Your application walkthrough, tailored

- 1 Confirm you are a first-year undergraduate student with 60 percent or more in Class 12.
- 2 Register at scholarships.reliancefoundation.org.
- 3 Complete the application with income and admission documents.
- 4 Take the mandatory online aptitude test seriously when the stage arrives.
- 5 Track your status on the official portal only.

Where to go when it stalls

- The official portal's support channels.
- Nothing else: no agents, no fees, no exceptions.

Renewal, for continuing students

The award continues across the degree; roughly 80 percent of each year's amount is disbursed upfront for tuition, subject to the programme's continuation conditions.

Documents to keep ready

- Class 12 marksheet with 60 percent or more
- First-year admission proof
- Household income proof

- Bank account details

Mistakes that cost people this scholarship

- Skipping the aptitude test. It is mandatory, and skipping it ends the application.
- Paying anyone to apply. The process is free at every stage; anyone charging you is a fraud.

Questions students ask about this scheme

Is there really no fee?

Correct. No application fee at any stage. Anyone collecting money in its name is a fraud.

What is the aptitude test like?

An online test that is part of selection. Details come from the official portal after you register; treat it seriously, it is mandatory.

Can second-year students apply?

No. First-year undergraduate students only.

Always confirm this scheme's current dates and conditions on the official portal before you apply. Portal listings can change during the season.

Part IV. Applying, Verifying and Protecting Your Money

The schemes are the what. This part is the how: the application walkthrough, the verification pipeline, the eight traps that kill applications, renewals, and what to do if things go wrong.

The application walkthrough

With your OTR done and your document folder ready, an application takes minutes. Done carelessly, it creates the defect that kills you in November. Slow down for these steps:

- 1 Log in with your OTR number and password on scholarships.gov.in.
- 2 Use the scheme search to list the schemes matching your category, course level and income.
- 3 Pick the scheme that matches your category certificate exactly. A minority student applies under the minority scheme even if they are also OBC; an SC student applies under the SC scheme, not the general merit scheme.
- 4 Fill personal, academic and category details exactly as they appear on the official documents, with the marksheets and admission letter in front of you. Enter percentages carefully; if your college gives CGPA, use the university's official conversion formula and never round up or estimate.
- 5 Enter your institute's NSP code, not the institution's own code or AISHE code. If your college is not registered on NSP, the principal must register it; ask the scholarship cell to confirm this before you submit.
- 6 Upload each document in the specified format, size and orientation. Blurry or partial scans are the fastest route to the defective queue.
- 7 Review every field before final submission. Most portal stages do not permit edits after submission.
- 8 Submit, then download and save the final submitted form with the application ID. That document is your proof on exam day, on verification day and on every follow-up call.
- 9 Tell your institute's scholarship cell or nodal officer that you have applied, and ask them to verify within their deadline.

The status words, translated

The portal uses a small set of status words, and every one of them has a precise meaning with a precise next action attached. Print this table and you will never stare at a status wondering what to do:

Status	What it means and what to do
Submitted	Your part is done. Nothing to do except the follow-up habit: check weekly, and make sure the institute knows.
Institute Pending	Waiting on Level 1. Visit the nodal officer with the printed form. This status after the institute deadline means rejected; treat it as urgent, not as waiting.
Defective	A named problem in a named document or field. Fix exactly that, inside the correction window, and resubmit.
District or State Pending	Level 1 cleared, Level 2 waiting. Nothing for you to do except keep checking; escalate through the institute if it crosses the nodal deadline.
Approved	Verification complete. The money is queued for PFMS. Keep the passbook handy and do not change the bank account.
Rejected	Read the reason first. If it is a technical error, raise a grievance on the portal with your application ID; if it is eligibility, prepare correctly for next cycle.
Paid or credit received	Keep the passbook entry with your records; renewal disputes are won with records.

The form, field by field

Most rejection traps live in the form itself. Here is the field-by-field discipline that avoids them:

Section of the form	The discipline
Personal details	Exactly as on Aadhaar, character for character, including spelling and date format. The OTR profile feeds this; a wrong OTR means a wrong everything.
Academic details	Marksheets and admission letter open in front of you. Percentages exactly as printed, official CGPA conversion only, correct year of admission and course duration.
Category	The category your certificate actually proves. A minority certificate does not support an OBC application even if you are both; the verification compares certificate to scheme.
Income	The honest combined figure from the current financial year's certificate, all earning members counted.
Bank details	The student's own Aadhaar-linked account, name matching Aadhaar exactly, correct IFSC, account number typed twice and checked twice.
Institute details	The institute's NSP code from the scholarship cell, never the AISHE code or the institute's own internal code.

Section of the form	The discipline
Uploads	Specified format, size and orientation, every corner visible, no photographs of photographs.
Final review	Every field re-read once before submit, because after submission most of them cannot be changed.

The 20-point pre-flight check

Before you press submit on any application, run this list. Twenty yes answers and your application is bulletproof against every trap in this handbook:

- 1 My OTR is approved and I am applying on that same account, not a new one.
- 2 I am applying as Fresh or Renewal, correctly for my situation.
- 3 My scheme's deadline for my application type is still in the future, and I know its exact date from the listing.
- 4 My category certificate matches the scheme's category exactly.
- 5 My income certificate is for the current financial year and covers all earning members.
- 6 If I am OBC, my NCL certificate is for the current financial year.
- 7 If I am applying on a disability basis, the certificate states 40 percent or more.
- 8 My marks entered match the marksheet exactly, with the official CGPA conversion if applicable.
- 9 My institute is registered on the NSP and I have its correct NSP code.
- 10 My bank account is my own, Aadhaar-linked, and the name matches Aadhaar exactly.
- 11 Every uploaded scan is complete, clear, and in the specified format and size.
- 12 I have checked my status words: I know what Submitted, Pending, Defective, Approved and Rejected each mean.
- 13 I have noted the institute and nodal verification deadlines for this scheme.
- 14 I know the combining rule and what my schemes say about other awards.
- 15 I have not paid anyone, and nobody has promised me a guaranteed scholarship.
- 16 I have a printed or saved copy of the final submitted form with the application ID.
- 17 My institute's nodal officer knows I have applied and has the printed form.
- 18 My Monday habit is set: scheme listing, application status, five minutes.
- 19 My document folder has a backup copy of everything I uploaded.
- 20 I know what to do if a Defective flag appears: fix it the same day, inside the window.

The verification pipeline: what happens after you submit

Submitting is not the end of your job; it is the end of the first third. After submission, your application passes through verification stages whose deadlines are separate from yours:

Stage	What happens
Level 1	Institute Nodal Officer (INO) at your school or college verifies your enrollment and details. For most 2026-27 schemes this closes 15 November 2026.
Level 2	District or State Nodal Officer (DNO, SNO or MNO) verification. For most schemes this closes 30 November 2026.
Later stages	Ministry-level scrutiny and, where applicable, defective application correction windows.
Payment	PFMS releases the money by DBT into your Aadhaar-linked bank account.

The single most common post-submission failure is students assuming their job ended at the submit button. It did not. Applications stuck at 'Institute Pending' after the institute deadline are automatically rejected. Check your status weekly on the portal, and physically visit your scholarship cell if verification has not moved. On average across schemes, the process from submission to money in the account runs in weeks, not days; the NMMSS extension notice of 1 September 2026 spelled out its verification dates for exactly this reason.

The eight rejection traps

These eight errors account for the overwhelming majority of rejected applications. Every one of them is avoidable with a day's effort:

- 1 Wrong institute code: entering your institution's own code or AISHE code instead of its NSP code, or applying when the institute is not registered on the portal. Verify the NSP registration and code with the scholarship cell first.
- 2 Expired OBC NCL certificate: OBC non-creamy layer certificates expire at the end of each financial year, unlike SC and ST certificates which are valid for life. Get a fresh NCL certificate every year before the window opens.
- 3 Income over the limit: limits vary by scheme, from Rs. 2.5 lakh to Rs. 8 lakh. Family income counts all earning members: parents, spouse and guardians. An income certificate showing one parent only, when both work, is a mismatch waiting to be caught.
- 4 Wrong category: applying under a scheme whose community or welfare category does not match your certificate. Verification compares your certificate against the scheme's category; a mismatch is a rejection.

- 5 Institute verification not followed up: your job continues after submission. Follow up with the scholarship cell, and check status weekly. 'Institute Pending' after the deadline means rejected.
- 6 Duplicate accounts: creating a new account when you forget a password, or filing fresh when you should have renewed, flags duplicates; both accounts can be rejected. Use Forgot Password, use Renewal.
- 7 Academic mismatches: wrong percentage, wrong CGPA conversion, wrong course duration, wrong year of admission or wrong roll number. Fill the academic section with the marksheet and admission letter open in front of you.
- 8 Saved but never submitted: creating an application is not submitting it. A saved draft has no deadline protection. Log back in, confirm the status says submitted, and download the final form.

If you are already rejected

If your application is rejected after the window closes, you cannot reapply for the same academic year. You can apply fresh in the next year, and if the rejection was a technical error, raise a grievance on the portal: genuine errors can sometimes be corrected. This is why applying early, within the first two weeks of the window, matters.

Renewals, done right

Renewal is simpler than fresh application because your OTR and history carry over, but it has its own failure modes. Renewal windows often differ from fresh windows, so check your scheme's listing, not the general calendar. Renewal depends on academic performance conditions, so a bad semester can end the scholarship; read the conditions before you assume continuity. And NSP specifically warns renewal students not to file duplicate fresh applications, because duplicates are rejected outright. The correct action is always the Renewal option on your existing account.

Follow the money: how DBT and PFMS actually pay you

Understanding the payment machinery stops half the anxiety students feel in November. Your scholarship money does not travel from a ministry to your college and then to you. After the final verification level, the sanctioned list goes to the Public Financial Management System, the government's payment engine, which executes a Direct Benefit Transfer into the bank account linked to your Aadhaar. Nobody in your college handles the money, and no clerk can 'release' it early for you.

Three practical consequences follow. First, your Aadhaar-bank link must be live; if the account was opened after you applied, update it in the portal's correction window if the scheme allows, or the transfer has nowhere to land. Second, the name on the bank account

must match Aadhaar exactly, because the payment engine compares them. Third, the transfer arrives as a credit with a scheme-specific description, so check the passbook statement and keep it with your application records; it is your proof if a renewal question ever comes up.

When the money does not arrive

If your status shows approved but the money has not landed, work the chain in order, and only in this order:

- 1 Check the application status on the portal. If it shows 'Institute Pending' or 'District Pending', the money is not late; the verification is. Go to the institute nodal officer, then the district officer, with your submitted form and documents.
- 2 If the status shows a 'Defective' flag, act inside the correction window with the exact document or field the flag names. Defective is fixable; ignored is fatal.
- 3 If verification is complete and payment is pending, check your bank branch for a failed or returned credit, which usually means a name or account mismatch. Fix the bank record, then raise the issue through the portal grievance option.
- 4 Raise a grievance on the NSP portal with your application ID for anything stuck beyond the notified timeline, and follow up with your institute's scholarship cell, which can escalate through state channels.
- 5 Never pay anyone to 'expedite' a payment. There is no such thing as a fast-track fee in DBT; there is only a fraud.

How scholarship scams actually work

Scam patterns repeat every season, and they all borrow the system's own vocabulary. Learn the patterns once and you are immune for life:

- The agent: someone offering to 'do your NSP registration' for a fee. Registration is free, OTR needs your own Aadhaar and face, and an agent cannot type your face for you.
- The percentage cut: an offer to 'guarantee' the scholarship for a share of the amount. Scholarships are decided by verification, not by influence, and this is extortion of a student.
- The fake deadline: an urgent message claiming the portal closes tomorrow, with a link to a lookalike site. The real portal is scholarships.gov.in and real deadlines are on the scheme listing.
- The fake site: a domain mimicking the portal design, harvesting OTR credentials and bank details. Check the address bar every single time.

- The document fee: a charge for 'form verification' or 'certificate processing'. No stage of any scheme in this handbook costs money.

One habit defeats all of them: type the portal address yourself, never through a link someone sent, and never pay anyone anything, ever. Both rules take ten seconds to follow.

What your nodal officer sees on the other side

Your institute's nodal officer logs into the same portal and sees a queue of applications from your school or college, each waiting for Level 1 verification. That officer is usually a teacher or clerk with this duty on top of a full-time job, which is why 'pending' happens so often. The fix is not anger, it is paperwork: hand over a printed copy of your submitted form with your documents attached, and ask for the verification to be done before the deadline, not on it. If the officer cannot be reached after genuine attempts, the escalation path is the principal and then the district education or welfare office for your scheme. Every rejection in this handbook that says 'verification lapsed' was avoidable at exactly this step.

Fraud protection: keep your money and your identity

Every scheme in this handbook applies free of cost through its official portal. NMMSS guidance is blunt: beware of fraudulent websites or agents claiming to register on your behalf for a fee. The same applies everywhere else. Government scholarship applications never require payment to a person, a WhatsApp number or an agent, and the Reliance Foundation scholarship explicitly charges no fee at any stage.

- The only portals you need: scholarships.gov.in for NSP schemes, and online-inspire.gov.in for INSPIRE. Everything else claiming a fee is suspect.
- Never share your OTR password, Aadhaar OTP or bank details with anyone offering 'guaranteed' scholarships.
- Deadline urgency is the fraudster's favourite tool; verify every date on the official portal before acting on any message.
- If someone asks for a percentage of the scholarship amount, that is extortion of a student, and it is a crime. Report it.

A chapter for parents

If you are a parent reading this, four things are in your hands and nobody else's. First, the income certificate: get it issued for the current financial year from the authorised revenue officer, with the correct year notation, because schemes verify it hardest. Second, the certificates: for OBC families, the non-cream layer certificate expires every financial year; for SC and ST families it is valid for life, but it must be from the competent authority. Third, the bank account: open a student account in the child's name, link Aadhaar, and make sure the name spelling matches Aadhaar exactly. Fourth, the follow-up: the child's school or college verifies the application, and a parent's phone call to the scholarship cell moves that verification faster than a student's second visit.

State scholarships: the quiet second layer

Nearly every state government runs its own post-matric scholarships, often layered on top of central schemes for SC, ST, OBC, minority and general students, and these are frequently the most under-applied-for schemes simply because they are less publicised nationally. Amounts and eligibility vary significantly by state. Some states run dedicated portals of their own, such as Maharashtra's MahaDBT, Karnataka's State Scholarship Portal, Uttar Pradesh's scholarship portal and West Bengal's OASIS; others list their schemes on the NSP's state-scheme listings.

- Check both places: your state's own portal, and the state schemes section of the NSP.
- State deadlines are different from central deadlines and are often earlier; find them now, not after the central applications.
- A state scholarship plus a central scheme is often possible; check both schemes' rules on other awards.
- Verify any state portal name through your school or the state government website before entering personal details.

Known state portals, to verify before use

State	Where to look
Maharashtra	MahaDBT, the state's direct benefit transfer portal for scholarships
Karnataka	The State Scholarship Portal (SSP) for post-matric schemes
Uttar Pradesh	The UP scholarship portal for school and post-matric schemes
West Bengal	OASIS for SC, ST and OBC scholarships
Madhya Pradesh	The MP scholarship portal for post-matric schemes
Other states	Search the official state name plus 'scholarship portal', then confirm the address through your school before using it

Portal names and addresses change as states upgrade their systems. Treat the list above as starting points to verify, never as final facts; the safe confirmation route is always your school or the state government's official website.

The week-by-week 2026-27 season calendar

The whole season on one page. Paste it where you study and tick off the weeks as they pass; a season managed weekly never becomes a crisis managed nightly.

When	What happens and what to do
Now (mid-September 2026)	Complete OTR if not done. Finish the document folder. File the 30 September schemes: NMMSS, CSSS renewal, Jammu and Kashmir renewal, beedi pre-matric, disability post-matric.
30 September 2026	First deadline block closes. Nothing filed by tonight for these schemes can be recovered this year.
Early October 2026	Verification follow-up for the September schemes (15 and 31 October dates). Start or polish the 31 October applications.
31 October 2026	The main deadline block closes: YASASVI post-matric and Top Class, CSSS fresh if opened, Pragati, Saksham, Swanath, PMSS, NEC, Top Class SC and ST schemes.
Early November 2026	First week of the verification season. Meet the nodal officer with printed forms; fix any defective flags inside the correction windows.
15 November 2026	Defective application verification and institute verification close for most schemes. Everything must have moved past Institute Pending by now.
Late November 2026	DNO, SNO and MNO verification closes 30 November for most schemes. Weekly status checks decide whether anything needs escalation.
December 2026 onward	Payment season. Watch the bank account, keep passbook statements, and start the document folder for next year: fresh income and NCL certificates in April and May.

When	What happens and what to do
Any week in between	Monday habit: open your scheme listings, check application status, five minutes.

Stacking: how much money is actually on your table

Students ask whether combining schemes is worth the paperwork. Here are four realistic, verifiable stacks, using the amounts from this handbook. Every stack assumes honest eligibility, current documents, and checking each scheme's rules on other awards before filing.

A Class 9 student in a government school, OBC, income under Rs. 2.5 lakh

NMMSS at Rs. 12,000 a year plus the YASASVI pre-matric allowance of Rs. 4,000 a year, both renewable, is Rs. 16,000 a year, Rs. 64,000 over Classes 9 to 12. The paperwork cost is one income certificate, one OBC NCL certificate, and two applications a year on one OTR account.

A board topper from a family under Rs. 8 lakh, entering a regular B.Sc. in physics

If you are in the top 1 percent of your board, INSPIRE-SHE alone is Rs. 80,000 a year for up to five years: Rs. 4 lakh over an integrated M.Sc., plus the mentorship grant each summer. Add the Reliance Foundation undergraduate scholarship in a year where you are eligible, and CSSS where its fresh window opens for you. This is the highest-value stack in the entire system, and it exists purely for students who choose basic sciences.

An SC student admitted to a notified premier institution

Top Class Education for SC students covers tuition plus up to Rs. 86,000 a year for living and books per the current listing. If a state SC scheme stacks on top under both schemes' rules, the family's contribution approaches zero for the entire degree.

A girl student entering an engineering diploma, income under the limit

AICTE Pragati at up to Rs. 50,000 a year toward tuition and incidentals, plus any state technical-education scholarship her state runs, plus a state post-matric scheme if her category qualifies. The diploma that looked unaffordable in June is funded by October.

Class 12 toppers: your sixty-day window

If you just got your Class 12 results and you are near the top of your board, the next sixty days pay better than any part-time job you will ever find. Here is the schedule that captures everything, assuming a typical June-to-August flow of results and openings:

- 1 Days 1 to 7: get the OTR done, open the Aadhaar-linked bank account if you do not have one, and order the income certificate for the current financial year.

- 2 Days 8 to 14: run the eligibility checker, shortlist your schemes, and register on the INSPIRE portal and the Reliance Foundation portal in the same sitting; they are separate from the NSP.
- 3 Days 15 to 30: file everything whose window is open. Board toppers filing early never regret it; the correction windows are generous in June and cruel in October.
- 4 Days 31 to 45: start the follow-up habit with your new college's scholarship cell, because institute verification is your newest job.
- 5 Days 46 to 60: review every submitted form once against your documents, fix anything flagged, and set the Monday reminder that carries you to November.

One decision outweighs every form in this chapter: what you study. If you are choosing between a professional course and a basic sciences degree, remember that INSPIRE pays Rs. 80,000 a year for up to five years, with mentorship, precisely to make that second choice easier. Know that before you lock your admission.

The stacking pattern

The pattern in every stack: one strong central scheme, one state scheme checked late (most people never check), and documents kept current every single year. That is the entire game.

Special situations, handled

I transferred colleges mid-course.

Inform the new college's nodal officer immediately and update the institute details if the correction window allows. Renewal at the new institute requires their verification, so hand over the printed application and documents in person.

My bank account changed after I applied.

Update it in the portal's correction window if the scheme allows. A DBT to a dead account is returned and stalls; a name mismatch between the new passbook and Aadhaar is the next most common cause.

My family income changed.

Renewal re-checks eligibility. Report the honest current income on the fresh certificate. Overstating to keep a scheme is fraud; understating is also fraud. The certificate is the truth, and the truth is applied to the limit table.

I lost access to my OTR mobile number.

Update the Aadhaar-linked mobile through the Aadhaar ecosystem first, then recover the portal account with Forgot Password. Never create a second account.

We moved states.

Central schemes follow you; state schemes do not automatically. Check the new state's portal and rules, and check the old state's continuing-benefit rules for schemes you already hold.

My school says it has no nodal officer.

An institute processing NSP applications must be registered on the portal. Escalate to the principal with the printed application; an unregistered institute means unverified means rejected.

My application is stuck as 'Defective' and the window is closing.

Fix exactly the named defect with exactly the named document, today. The correction window exists for this; it does not extend.

I missed everything this year.

Prepare now for next cycle: OTR today, certificates in April and May, and the portal opens 1 June. Being ready in June beats being rushed in October; most rejections happen to October people.

Renewal strategy: keeping the money for the whole degree

Fresh applications get the attention, but renewals carry most of the money, because a renewal repeated across a three or five year course is worth several times one award. The strategy is boring and effective. Use the same OTR account every year, never a new one. Keep the certificate cycle on the calendar: income certificate and OBC NCL renewed in April and May, before the June portal opening. File renewal in the first weeks of the window, not the last. Keep every year's submitted form, payment passbook entry and marksheet in one folder, because a renewal dispute is won with records. And treat the institute verification as your job: the pattern of rejected renewals is identical to rejected fresh applications, pending at Level 1.

Part V. Planner and Reference

Everything you need to act, in order: a four-week plan, the master table of every scheme in this handbook, the questions students actually ask, the words the system uses, and the directory of official places.

The four-week application plan

If you do one task a day from this plan, every application in this handbook can be finished and defended. Adjust week one to today's date if you are starting late; if your deadline is 30 September 2026, compress the plan into a week and start today.

When	Do
Week 1	Complete OTR. Collect every document on the master checklist. Get the income certificate issued for the current financial year. Confirm your institute's NSP code with the scholarship cell. Fix the bank account name if it does not match Aadhaar.
Week 2	Run the NSP eligibility checker. List every scheme you qualify for. File the 30 September schemes first: NMMSS if school level, CSSS renewal, Jammu and Kashmir scheme renewal, beedi pre-matric.
Week 3	File the 31 October schemes you qualify for. Upload clean scans. Download every submitted form with its application ID. Tell the nodal officer in person.
Week 4	Check status weekly. Chase institute verification before 15 November 2026. Fix any 'defective' flag immediately through the correction window. Watch the UGC schemes' opening announcement; their windows are short.

The master table: every scheme in this handbook

Amounts and dates are as verified on 16 September 2026 from official sources; confirm the live listing on the portal before submitting.

Scheme	Who it is for	What you get	2026-27 close
NMMSS	Class 9, government schools, income under Rs. 3.5 lakh	Rs. 12,000 a year	30 Sep 2026
PM YASASVI Pre-Matric	OBC, EBC, DNT in Classes 9-10, government schools	Rs. 4,000 a year	See listing
PM YASASVI Post-Matric	OBC, EBC, DNT after Class 10	Rs. 5,000 to 20,000 a year	31 Oct 2026

Scheme	Who it is for	What you get	2026-27 close
YASASVI Top Class School	OBC, EBC, DNT at notified schools, Class 9-12	Up to Rs. 1.25 lakh a year	31 Oct 2026
YASASVI Top Class College	OBC, EBC, DNT at notified institutions	Full tuition, living, books	31 Oct 2026
CSSS (PM-USP)	Top 20 percent of Class 12 boards, income under Rs. 8 lakh	Rs. 10,000-20,000 a year	Renewal 30 Sep; fresh TBA
Top Class for SC Students	SC students at notified institutions	Tuition plus up to Rs. 86,000	31 Oct 2026
ST National Scholarship	ST students in higher education	Up to Rs. 2.5 lakh tuition plus allowances	31 Oct 2026
Post-Matric, Disabilities	Students with 40 percent or more disability	Up to Rs. 1.40 lakh fee support	30 Sep 2026
Wards of Beedi, Cine, IOMC, LSDM Workers	Children of eligible workers	Up to Rs. 25,000 a year	Pre 30 Sep; Post 31 Oct
PM Scholarship Schemes (3)	Wards of police, CAPF, Assam Rifles, RPF and RPSF personnel	Rs. 3,000 a month	31 Oct 2026
Jammu and Kashmir Special Scheme	J and K, Ladakh domicile students	Up to Rs. 3 lakh a year (medical listing)	Renewal 30 Sep 2026
AICTE Pragati	Girl students in technical degree or diploma	Up to Rs. 50,000 a year	31 Oct 2026
AICTE Saksham	Specially abled students, technical courses	Up to Rs. 50,000 a year	31 Oct 2026
AICTE Swanath	Orphans and critical family situations, technical	Rs. 50,000 a year	31 Oct 2026
NEC Merit Scholarship	North Eastern Region students	Up to Rs. 30,000 a year (PhD listing)	31 Oct 2026 (renewal)
UGC National PG Scholarship	First-year PG students	Rs. 15,000 a month (listing)	Not yet opened
Ishan Uday	North Eastern Region UG and PG students	Rs. 8,000 a month (listing)	Not yet opened

Scheme	Who it is for	What you get	2026-27 close
INSPIRE-SHE	Top 1 percent Class 12 in basic sciences	Rs. 80,000 a year	Own portal, watch call
Reliance Foundation UG	First-year UG, 60 percent or more in Class 12	Up to Rs. 2 lakh over degree	Open; see portal

Amounts shown are the published figures for the 2026-27 listings where available. Where a scheme's support depends on course group or institution, the range or ceiling is shown; the scheme chapters carry the detail.

Frequently asked questions

Is there one last date for all NSP scholarships?

No. Several schemes close 30 September 2026 and most others 31 October 2026, with verification stages running into November. Your exact scheme's dates are on the official scheme listing; that is the only date that counts.

Can I apply for more than one scholarship?

On the NSP you may apply for one merit-based scheme and one or more welfare-based schemes, subject to each scheme's eligibility. Some schemes ask you to declare other awards; always declare.

What if I filled the form but did not submit it?

A saved draft is not an application. Log back in, complete the submission, and download the final form with the application ID.

My college rejected my application at verification. What now?

Check the exact rejection reason in your status, contact your Institute Nodal Officer immediately, and ask whether correction is permitted. Keep your final form, admission receipt and documents ready for the follow-up.

How does the money actually arrive?

By Direct Benefit Transfer into your Aadhaar-linked bank account, for most schemes through the PFMS. No school or agent touches it.

Is a private school student eligible for NMMSS?

No. NMMSS covers State Government, government-aided and local body schools only.

Does CSSS cover distance education?

No. CSSS covers regular, full-time courses.

Can engineering students get INSPIRE?

No. INSPIRE-SHE supports basic and natural sciences only, in 18 listed subjects. Biotechnology, computer science and professional courses are outside it.

When do the UGC PG Scholarship and Ishan Uday open?

They had not opened as of early September 2026. Watch the portal; their windows are typically short.

My OBC certificate is from last year. Is that fine?

No. OBC non-creamy layer certificates expire at the end of each financial year. Get a fresh one; expired NCL certificates are the most common OBC rejection.

Do I need to apply for renewal, or is it automatic?

You apply. Renewal is filed by you on the portal each year, subject to academic performance conditions.

Someone is offering to get my scholarship for a fee. Should I pay?

No. Every application in this handbook is free. Paying an agent risks your money, your identity and your application.

What is the verification deadline for my scheme?

For most 2026-27 schemes: institute and defective verification by 15 November 2026, nodal verification by 30 November 2026. Schemes closing 30 September have earlier verification dates (mid and end October). Check your listing.

Can a state scholarship be combined with a central one?

Often yes, but check both schemes' rules on other awards. State deadlines are usually earlier than central ones.

I am in my second year of college. Can I get the Reliance Foundation scholarship?

No. It is for first-year undergraduate students only.

What if my bank account name does not exactly match my Aadhaar?

Fix it at the bank before applying. The DBT engine compares the two, and mismatches stall or fail payments.

Where do I complain if something is genuinely wrong?

Use the grievance option on the NSP portal for portal and scheme issues, and your institute's nodal officer for verification issues. For INSPIRE, use the contact channels on its own portal.

What is the difference between a merit-based and a welfare-based scheme?

Merit schemes reward performance, like CSSS for board percentile or INSPIRE for the top 1 percent. Welfare schemes lower financial barriers for specific communities and situations. The portal lets you hold one merit plus one or more welfare scholarships, subject to each scheme's rules.

Can I edit my application after submitting?

Most stages do not allow it. That is why the review-before-submit step exists in the walkthrough. If a genuine error is flagged, work the defective application correction window.

What does 'defective application' mean?

A flag on a submitted application naming a specific document or field problem. It is fixable within the correction window shown on your scheme listing; ignored defective applications do not proceed.

My CGPA does not convert cleanly to a percentage. What do I enter?

Use your university's official conversion formula, exactly, without rounding up or estimating. Wrong conversions are a classic verification-stage rejection.

Do I need a new OTR every year?

No. OTR is created once and stays with you across your academic career. Use the same account every year, and use Forgot Password rather than a new account if you lose access.

My parents' combined income is above one limit but below another. Which schemes apply?

The income limits vary by scheme, from Rs. 2.5 lakh to Rs. 8 lakh. Run the portal's eligibility checker with your actual combined income and apply to what it shows honestly.

Is there a fee to apply? Any fee at all?

No. Every government scheme in this handbook applies free on its official portal, and the Reliance Foundation scholarship charges no fee at any stage.

Who is my Institute Nodal Officer?

The teacher or clerk at your school or college assigned to verify scholarship applications. Ask the office or scholarship cell for the name and office timing, and meet them in person.

What if my school or college is not registered on NSP?

The institution must register on the portal; that is the principal's responsibility. Ask the office to do it now, because an unregistered institute means your application can never be verified.

Can I apply for a state scheme and a central scheme in the same year?

Often yes. Check both schemes' rules on other awards and declare everything. State deadlines are usually earlier than central ones.

How long until the money arrives?

After all verification levels clear, payment follows through PFMS by DBT. Timelines vary by scheme and season; the part you control is verification speed, which is why the follow-up chapters exist.

The words the system uses

Term	Meaning
NSP	National Scholarship Portal, scholarships.gov.in , the single online window for central government scholarships.
OTR	One Time Registration: your 14-digit permanent NSP identity, created with Aadhaar and required before any application.
DBT	Direct Benefit Transfer: money paid straight into your Aadhaar-linked bank account.
PFMS	Public Financial Management System: the government's payment engine that executes most scholarship DBT payments.
INO	Institute Nodal Officer: the person at your school or college who does Level 1 verification.
DNO, SNO, MNO	District, State and Ministry Nodal Officers: the higher verification levels after your institute.
NCL	Non-Creamy Layer: the OBC certificate type, which expires at the end of each financial year.
EBC	Economically Backward Classes.
DNT	De-notified, Nomadic and Semi-Nomadic Tribes.
CSSS	Central Sector Scheme of Scholarship for College and University Students, run under PM-USP.
PM-USP	Pradhan Mantri Uchchatar Shiksha Protsahan, the umbrella programme for higher education scholarships including CSSS and the Jammu and Kashmir scheme.
YET	YASASVI Entrance Test, conducted by the National Testing Agency for PM YASASVI selection streams.
AICTE	All India Council for Technical Education, the body behind Pragati, Saksham and Swanath.
UGC	University Grants Commission, which runs the National PG Scholarship and Ishan Uday.
INSPIRE-SHE	Innovation in Science Pursuit for Inspired Research, Scholarship for Higher Education, run by the Department of Science and Technology.
NTA	National Testing Agency.
Benchmark disability	A disability certified as 40 percent or more, the eligibility line for disability schemes.

Official places, and only these

- scholarships.gov.in: the National Scholarship Portal, for every NSP scheme in this handbook.
- online-inspire.gov.in: the INSPIRE-SHE portal, separate from NSP.
- scholarships.reliancefoundation.org: the Reliance Foundation scholarship portal.
- nsp.gov.in redirects to the portal; use the official link and never a shortened link sent on WhatsApp.
- Your state's own scholarship portal for state schemes; confirm its address through your school or the state government website.

Appendix. Your Worksheets

Print these pages or copy them into a notebook. They are the three trackers that keep a scholarship season under control: the document tracker, the application tracker, and the verification calendar. Ten minutes of filling on the day you start beats an hour of panic in November.

Worksheet 1: The document tracker

Document	Needed for	Status	Where it is
Aadhaar card (own, mobile linked)	OTR, every scheme		
Bank passbook first page	DBT payment		
Income certificate (current FY)	All means-tested schemes		
Category or NCL certificate	Category schemes		
Class 12 marksheet	CSSS, INSPIRE, college schemes		
Admission or bonafide proof	College schemes		
Institute NSP code	Every NSP application		
Passport photo (portal format)	NSP profile		
Disability certificate (if applicable)	Disability schemes		
Domicile certificate (if applicable)	Region-specific schemes		

Worksheet 2: The application tracker

No.	Scheme	Fresh or renewal	Deadline	Date submitted	Application ID
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					

Worksheet 3: The verification calendar

Write the dates for each scheme you applied to, then check the portal every week until every row says complete. Verification dates for most 2026-27 schemes: institute level by 15 November 2026, nodal level by 30 November 2026; schemes closing 30 September run about two weeks earlier. Write your scheme's own dates below as they appear on its listing.

Scheme	Institute verification by	Nodal verification by	Status checked on

Where every fact in this handbook comes from

This handbook was researched and verified on 16 September 2026 from official and primary sources. Where a figure came from a release or listing, it is named below, so you can re-verify anything before you rely on it.

- The National Scholarship Portal scheme listings for 2026-27 (scholarships.gov.in): scheme names, categories, amounts where listed, opening and closing dates, and verification stage dates.
- Press Information Bureau, Government of India: the NMMSS 2026-27 extension release of 1 September 2026 (Release ID 2305633), and the PM YASASVI release of 23 October 2024 for the scheme's structure, sub-schemes, allowances and 2023-24 beneficiary figures.
- The Department of Science and Technology: the INSPIRE-SHE scheme page and the official SHE FAQs (online-inspire.gov.in) for eligibility, the Rs. 80,000 structure, the 18 supported subjects and the summer research requirement.
- The Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment (socialjustice.gov.in) and its scheme documents for PM YASASVI's Top Class School and College conditions and ceilings.
- The Times of India Education Times scholarship guide of 8 September 2026 and the Shiksha NSP 2026-27 listing summary of 4 September 2026, used as secondary confirmations of portal dates and amounts.
- The Reliance Foundation scholarship portal (scholarships.reliancefoundation.org) for the undergraduate scholarship's conditions and amounts.

Scheme terms change during the season, and the portal listing is always the live truth. This handbook's promise is narrower and firmer: nothing in it was invented, and everything in it tells you exactly which official source to check it against.

Everything, in one line

The complete action, in one line: complete OTR today, file the 30 September schemes this week, file the 31 October schemes next week, then guard the verification stages until the money lands.

This handbook was researched and verified from official sources on 16 September 2026: the National Scholarship Portal scheme listings, Press Information Bureau releases, the Department of Science and Technology's INSPIRE documents, and ministry scheme documents. Scheme terms and dates change during the season; the official portal is always the final word.